Buy me a coffee

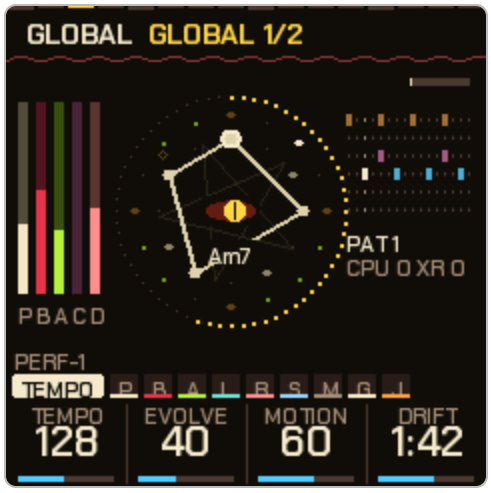
MANUAL

PERF-1 is free firmware that turns your M-VAVE FM-1 into a groovebox that plays by itself. Switch it on and a piece of music starts: drums, a bass line, a pad, an acid line and a short plucked melody, made up as it plays so it never repeats exactly. There are seventeen styles, from techno and house to lofi, reggae, drum and bass and industrial, with ten pieces each.

You don't have to program anything to get going. You steer the music: change the chords, break the beat down and bring it back, mute parts, throw on effects, or let the auto-DJ do it for you. When you want to go deeper, almost everything can be edited, from the drum steps to the sounds, and any piece you shape can be saved. The FM-1 also works as a USB audio and MIDI device, so you can record what you play straight into your computer.

If you're new, read **Start here** below first. The numbered sections after it are the full reference.

This manual is for **PERF-1 0.15**. PERF-1 is made by deamonSLINKY, based on HYP-1 by RedtailWorks, and it's free and open source (GPL-3.0). It's still young and changes often, so keep a way back to the stock firmware (section 1 explains how).



The Tempo page, the home screen

START HERE: YOUR FIRST HOUR

This guide is for your first hour. No music theory needed, nothing to set up. Every step is one thing to press, and what you will hear.

When you want every detail, the quick manual has every control on eight pages, and the rest of this manual, from section 1 on, explains everything. This part is also a printable PDF.

What PERF-1 is

PERF-1 turns your M-VAVE FM-1 into a little band that plays by itself. Switch it on and music starts: drums, a bass, a soft pad, a squelchy "acid" line and a plucked melody, all made up on the spot so it never repeats exactly.

You are the conductor. You don't have to play notes. You change the chords, break the beat down and bring it back, throw effects on, mute things, and keep the moments you like.

Before you start

- **Try it without installing.** The emulator runs PERF-1 in your web browser, with sound. Every step in this guide works there too.
- **Installing** takes a couple of minutes with the web installer in Chrome or Edge. Use a USB cable that carries data, not a charge-only one.
- **You can always go back.** The same installer page puts M-VAVE's own firmware back. Anything you saved on the stock firmware may be lost when you switch, so keep copies of what you care about.

The buttons you need today

Only a few. The rest can wait.

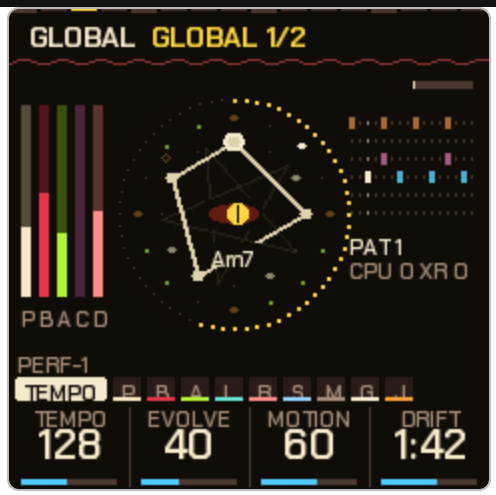


The FM-1's panel: the knobs top left and right, the screen in the middle, the buttons to its right, the keys below

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES FOR YOU TODAY
MASTER knob	Volume.
PLAY	Stop and start the music.
EDIT	Move on to the next chord.
The **keys**	Change the notes the music uses.
PRESETS knob	The next piece of music.
SAVE	Break the beat down, then build it back up.
FX	Effects.
HOME	Back to the start page. Press it whenever you feel lost.
GLO	The Global page. Hold it for the mixer.

Your first five minutes

1. Switch it on and listen. After a short animation, a piece starts playing on its own. Turn **MASTER** to a comfortable level. Nothing you press in this guide can break anything.



The home screen: the five parts' levels on the left, the circle shows the chord, the drum pattern on the right

2. Tap EDIT. At the start of the next bar the chord changes. The whole band follows: the bass, the pad and the melodies all move to fit. Tap it a few more times.

3. Tap a few keys. Each key adds a note to the music or takes one away. Tap any key, listen, tap another. There are no wrong notes to find: the band only ever plays the notes you have left on. Tap a key again to put it back.

4. Turn PRESETS one click. A new piece starts: a new key, a new tempo, new sounds. There are ten pieces in each style.

5. Hold GLO and turn PRESETS. Now you are changing the style itself. There are nineteen: techno, lofi, house, dubstep, dub, drum and bass, breaks, garage, electro, trap, disco, funk, reggae, synthwave, amapiano, trip-hop, industrial, psytrance and dark forest. Let go of GLO when you find one you like.

Make it move

6. Tap SAVE: a breakdown. At the next bar the drums drop out and the music gets softer and dreamier.



A breakdown: the circle thins out and the eye closes

7. Tap SAVE again: the build and the drop. The drums come back climbing for a few bars, there is a short silence, and then everything hits at once. This is the moment DJs live for. Tap SAVE, wait, tap SAVE, and you have done it.



A build: the top of the screen counts the bars to the drop

8. Press FX: effects on the keys. Every key is now an effect, and the screen shows their names.



The FX screen: each effect's name next to its key

- **Tap** a key and the effect stays on.
- **Hold** a key and the effect lasts only while you hold it.
- Tap the same key again to switch it off, or tap **OCT-** to switch every effect off at once.
- Press **FX** again to leave. Try the gate, the phaser, the tape and the beat repeats.

The Perform screen

9. Press HOME, then HOME again (not too quickly). This is the Perform screen: the eight parts of the band, and a **mood** bar.



The Perform screen: the eight parts, the four scenes, the mood bar

10. Turn ALGORITHM, the knob that sets the mood. Turn it left for calm and sparse, right for busy and bright. The acid, the hats, the melody, the bass and the reverb all change together.

11. Tap the keys to mute parts. On this screen the keys switch parts of the band off and on. The screen shows which key is which. Try muting the kick drum, listen to how much it changes, then bring it back.

12. Let it play itself. Hold **GLO** and tap the **F5** key (the second white key from the right). "DJ" lights up at the top of the screen. Now PERF-1 runs breakdowns, builds and drops on its own, like a DJ. Do the same again to switch it off.

Keep what you like

13. Save the piece. If you have changed a piece and like it, press **GLO**, then **SAVE**. The screen says it has been stored, and it is there next time you switch on.



Stored: the top of the screen says so

Every style keeps its own ten pieces.

To put a piece back the way it was at the start, go to **GLO** and hold **SEL** and **SAVE** together for a moment.

When you want more

You don't need any of this to have fun, but it is there.

- **Turn SELECT** to walk through the pages. Each page has four knobs underneath the screen. The page name tells you what they change: the pad, the bass, the acid, the drums, the reverb and much more.
- **The Jam page** (turn SELECT past Global) turns the keys into a keyboard you can play along on. It only plays notes that fit, so you can play freely.
- **Hold HOME** for the settings.
- **The SET page** has an **Intro** that starts with just a pad and brings the band in one part at a time over a few minutes. Great for mixing in, or for playing over. You get there by holding **SEL** and pressing **FX**, then turning SELECT.



The SET page: Rounds, Ramp, Intro

- The quick manual is eight pages to print and keep beside the FM-1.

If something goes wrong

- **Lost on some page?** Press **HOME**.
- **An effect won't go away?** Press **FX**, then **OCT-**, then **FX** again.
- **The music stopped?** Press **PLAY**.
- **A piece sounds odd after a lot of changes?** Turn PRESETS to another piece and back, or reset it with **SEL** and **SAVE** held on the **GLO** page.
- **Want the original firmware back?** Use the installer page: "Back to the stock firmware" at the bottom.
- **Found a bug or have an idea?** Tell us on GitHub. Most of the newest features came from ideas like yours.

Words you will see

WORD	MEANS
Piece	One song: its key, tempo, sounds and drum patterns. Ten in each style.
Genre	A style of music, with its own drums, sounds and habits. Nineteen of them.
Pad	The soft, long chords in the background.
Bass	The low notes.
Acid	The squelchy, twisting line, after the classic Roland TB-303.
Pluck	The short, plucked melody on top.
Chord	The group of notes the band is playing around right now. EDIT moves it on.
Scale	The set of notes the music is allowed to use. The keys switch them on and off.
Breakdown, build, drop	Calm down, climb back up, then everything hits at once. SAVE runs them.
Latch	An effect that stays on after you tap its key.
Auto-DJ	PERF-1 running the breakdowns, builds and drops by itself.

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1 INSTALL

You can try PERF-1 before you install it. The PERF-1 emulator runs the same firmware in your web browser, with sound. Play it with the mouse, a touch screen or your computer keyboard.

Installing PERF-1

1. Open the web installer in Chrome or Edge.
2. Connect the FM-1 straight to the computer with a USB cable that carries data (some cables only charge). You don't need a hub, a probe or Transporter.
3. Close any other program that uses the FM-1's MIDI port, such as your DAW (recording software).
4. When the browser asks, allow MIDI with SysEx. SysEx is the kind of MIDI message the installer uses to send the firmware.
5. Wait until the **Install** button isn't grey (the page is still loading the firmware). The line under it names the version it will write (`PERF-1 0.15.1`, for example). If that's older than you expected, hard-refresh the page (Ctrl+F5, or Cmd+Shift+R on a Mac) so the browser doesn't use an old saved copy.
6. Press **Install**.

The bar and the line above it show each stage: verifying, switching to update mode, writing, restarting, done. **Don't unplug the cable or close the page while it writes.** The page asks before it lets you leave. When it's finished, the FM-1 restarts into PERF-1 and the page checks that it reports the right version.

> Installing firmware is at your own risk. The author accepts no responsibility if your FM-1 is damaged or misbehaves because of this custom firmware. Anything you stored (pieces, settings, DX7 voices) may be lost when the firmware is replaced: keep your own copies of the .syx files you load.

Going back to the stock firmware

"Back to the stock firmware", at the bottom of the same page, puts M-VAVE's own FM-1 firmware, V15, back on the unit.

1. Download the file the page links to, `FM-1.fwsc`. It's also on m-vave.com/download. M-VAVE's link now gives V16. For V15, the page also links the copy of M-VAVE's original file the Internet Archive kept (V15); the page checks either file's fingerprint before it writes anything.

2. Choose that file on the page. The page checks the file's SHA-256 fingerprint and refuses any other file.
3. Connect the FM-1 and press **Install the stock firmware**.

It works from PERF-1, from safe mode and from update mode. M-VAVE's own updater, M-UPGRADE (Downloads, PC Software), works too from PERF-1 0.16.13 on. M-UPGRADE 3.11 doesn't find older PERF-1 builds ("A USB MIDI device is present but did not answer"): use this page's button for those.

V16. M-UPGRADE now offers M-VAVE's newer firmware, V16 (`FM-1_016`). From PERF-1 0.16.15 on you can go either way: M-UPGRADE takes PERF-1 straight to V16, and this page installs PERF-1 on an FM-1 that runs V16. This page's button takes V15's or V16's file. (V16 changes the FM-1's boot head, the first 16 KB of its memory. PERF-1 lets that change happen only between M-VAVE's own V15 and V16 heads.) An older PERF-1 shows `UPDATE FAILED` and M-UPGRADE times out (error 258). There, choose V15's `FM-1.fwsc` with M-UPGRADE's **Select firmware**, or use this page's button, then update the stock V15 to V16 with M-UPGRADE.

One program at a time. On Windows only one program can use the FM-1's MIDI port. This page and the Pieces page let go of it 4 seconds after they last talked to the FM-1 (Live status keeps it while it runs), so M-UPGRADE or your music software can open it with the page still open. If a program says the FM-1 is busy or "present but did not answer", close the other programs and pages that use it, then unplug the FM-1 and plug it back in.

Update mode

In update mode the installer can write to the FM-1. To enter it yourself, hold **OCT-** and **OCT+** together for 5 seconds while PERF-1 is running.

- After 2 seconds the screen counts down: `UPDATE MODE IN 3..`.
- Let go before the end and it says `UPDATE MODE CANCELLED`.
- At 5 seconds the FM-1 goes into update mode and shows `UBOOT`.

If an install is cut off, the FM-1 stays in update mode until a write finishes. Press **Install** again. If the page says it lost the FM-1, unplug the cable and plug it back in first.

Safe mode

If PERF-1 crashes or freezes twice in a row while starting up, the FM-1 starts in safe mode instead. The screen is black and says `PERF-1 SAFE MODE`, with the address of the crash at the bottom. There's no sound, but USB works. From here you can:

- reinstall from the web installer, or

- press **PLAY** to try starting PERF-1 again.

If starting keeps failing even then, the FM-1 goes into update mode by itself, ready for the installer.

If PERF-1 crashes while it's running, the next start tells you: the screen shows `RESTARTED AFTER A CRASH` and a `PC` address for two and a half seconds. If you report the crash, note that address.

Recovering an FM-1 that won't start

An install that was cut off (PERF-1 0.16.17 on). If the power or the cable goes while PERF-1 is being installed, switch the FM-1 on again. The key lights flash three times and the screen stays dark: it is waiting for the installer. Plug it in, open the Install page and press **Install** again; it finishes the job. To get there on purpose, hold **OCT-** alone while you switch the FM-1 on. One long flash instead means that rescue was not possible; the FM-1 is then in the chip's own USB mode (below). This comes from ChoralRoot's boot stub, as Melodee uses it. It is **experimental** in PERF-1: the method is tested in Melodee and ChoralRoot, and PERF-1 boots through it on every start, but its own copy hasn't been through a cut-off install yet, so don't rely on it on purpose. The first install of 0.16.17 over an older PERF-1 has a moment, early on, that isn't protected yet: keep the cable in and the power on until it's done. Installing the stock firmware or another firmware removes it.

- **Covered:** a bad PERF-1 install. The installer checks the package before sending it, checks each packet it writes, and reads the FM-1's version back after the restart. On the FM-1 there's safe mode, update mode after four failed starts, the **OCT-** + **OCT+** hold, and a USB command that enters update mode. The installer works from all of them.
- **Not covered:** a damaged start-up sector or boot loader (the part of the memory that starts the FM-1), or the power or cable going during a write before the installer has saved its record of where to resume. The protection for cut-off writes is reasoned from the design and has **not** been tested with a real power cut. No hardware way in (test pads, a strap, a key combination) has been found for this chip. An FM-1 that fails like that may be gone for good.

If the FM-1 won't start but still reaches the chip's own update mode (it shows up on USB as 4C4A:8057, `UBOOT`), the PERF-1 source has a rescue tool, `tools/fm1_rescue.py` (and its wrapper `fm1_rescue.sh`). It puts the stock V15 back from a Mac, using sudo, `pyusb` and `libusb-package`. It backs up the whole memory first, writes only the 4 KiB sectors between 0x4000 and 0x93000 that differ from V15, reads everything back to check, and accepts only the exact V15 file. It was written for an FM-1 stuck crashing at start-up, and it uses FM-1-transporter's method, which that project tested on real hardware. Treat it as a last resort, not a guarantee. Otherwise, recovery needs FM-1-transporter or hardware you may not have.

2 GETTING STARTED

New to PERF-1? **Start here**, at the top of this manual, walks you through your first hour. This is the short version.

1. Switch it on. The **deamonSLINKY** card shows (the slinky mascot hops twice and blinks, then the name and PRESENTS), then the **PERF-1** card (the version, "by deamonSLINKY", "based on HYP-1 by RedtailWorks"), with sixteen steps filling in and the white keys lighting with them. Any button or key skips the cards. Then a random piece from the HYPNO bank starts playing.
2. Turn **SELECT** to move through the pages. The four knobs under the screen change what each page shows.
3. Press **SEQ** for the drums. Hold it for the step sequencer, and tap the white keys to change the beat.
4. Tap keys to change the scale: each key adds its note or takes it away. Turn **PRESETS** for another piece. Hold **GLO** and turn **PRESETS** for another genre. On a voice's page, hold **SEL** and turn **ALGORITHM** to hear that voice's other sounds.
5. Want to play the bass yourself? Press **LFO** for the bass page, then hold **SEL** and press **ENV**. The bass stops playing its own part and the keys play it instead. Press **SEL** + **ENV** again to hand it back. The **JAM** page (turn **SELECT** past Global) is a keyboard that never changes the scale.
6. Tap **SAVE** for a breakdown on the next bar. Tap it again for a build and then the drop. A build lasts four bars (two in trap, lofi and trip-hop, eight in house).
7. Press **FX** for the effects. Tap a key to latch its effect on, or hold the key to play the effect only while you hold it.
8. **HOME** goes to the Tempo page. Press **HOME** again, not too quickly, for the Perform screen. Press it twice quickly for the visualizers. Hold it for the settings.
9. Like a HYPNO piece? Go to **Global** (**GLO**) and press **SAVE** to store it. Storing works in every genre: a piece you store in lofi or house stays there.

3 CONTROLS

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
MASTER	Volume.
SELECT	Steps through the pages in order. With **HOME** held: the tempo, from any page. In the FX menu: the bank (FX, BEAT FX, FLEX BEAT, DJ SNIPS), or inside an effect's settings, the next settings page. On the visualizers: the next one.
PRESETS	The piece, 1 to 10. With **SEL** held, the new piece starts on the next bar. With **GLO** held: the genre.
ALGORITHM	The mode of the scale, which sets its mood (Aeolian is the natural minor, Dorian a brighter minor, Phrygian a darker one, Mixolydian a major with a flat seventh). With **SEL** held: the sound of the voice on screen (on the drum pages, the whole kit). On the Perform screen and the visualizers: the mood.
KNOB1-KNOB4	The four values (a, b, c, d) of the page on screen.
OCT-	Down an octave, to -3. On a voice's pages it moves that voice (pad, bass or acid; the pluck goes down to -2). On any other page it moves the whole song. In the sequencer it picks the previous drum. In the FX menu it turns every effect off.
OCT+	Up an octave, to +3, the same way. In the sequencer it picks the next drum.
FX	Opens and closes the effects menu. Press it twice quickly for the settings of the effect you used last.
SEL	Shift: hold it while you use another control (section 12).
ENV	The Pad page. Again: Pad env, Pad LFO, Chords, Progression. With **SEL** held: takes the voice on screen off its automatic part so you play it by hand (again: hands it back).
LFO	The Bass page. Again: Bass env, Bass LFO, Bass line, Bass steps.
ARP	The Acid page. Again: Acid env, Acid line, Acid answer, Acid steps, Pluck, Pluck 2, Deja vu, Pluck steps.
EDIT	The next chord, on the next bar. Held: the Progression page, your own chords.
GLO	The Global page: root, theme, tune, genre. Here **SAVE** stores the piece. Held: the mix map (mutes, solos, scenes, the auto-DJ, tap tempo) and the load meter. Held with **PRESETS**: the genre. With **SEL** held: remote (section 17).
HOME	The Tempo page. Again: the Perform screen, then back to Tempo. Twice quickly: the visualizers. Held: the settings. Held with **SELECT**: the tempo.
SAVE	A breakdown on the next bar. Again: a build and the drop. Held: the drop. On Global: stores the piece.
SEQ	The Drums page. Again: Links, Kit, Drum drift, Groove, Steps, Feel, Phrase. Held: the sequencer. Tapped in the sequencer: back to Drums. With **SEL** held: the links on and off.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
PLAY	Play and stop.
REC	Freeze: the chord holds and the reverb rings on until you press it again. With **SEL**: Capture, which writes the bar you played on Jam into the acid line or the pluck loop (section 10).
White keys	The scale: each key adds or removes its note (the root stays). On the pages of a voice played by hand, and on Jam: that voice. In the sequencer: the 16 steps. In the FX menu: the effects. On Perform, the visualizers, and with **GLO** held: the track mix.
Black keys	The same as the white keys.

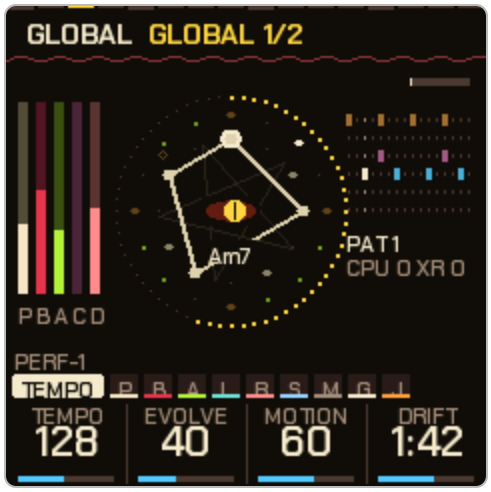
Pressing a group's button again steps through that group's pages. Pressing it from another page takes you back to the page you were last on in that group.

Holds and double taps

GESTURE	TIME	DOES
Hold **SEQ**	0.4 s	Opens the sequencer.
Hold **SAVE**	0.5 s	The drop, straight away on the next bar.
Hold **SEL** + **SAVE** on Global	1.5 s	Puts the piece back to factory. From 0.4 s a card says `KEEP HOLDING: FACTORY`. A plain **SAVE** on Global only stores.
Hold **HOME**	0.7 s	The settings pages (**SELECT** walks them).
Hold **GLO**	0.4 s	The mix map.
Hold **SEL** alone	0.4 s	A card shows what shift does on this page.
Hold **EDIT**	0.4 s	The Progression page.
Hold another button alone	0.9 s	A card says what it does (**ENV**, **LFO**, **ARP**, **REC**, **OCT-**, **OCT+**).
Tap an effect key	under 0.25 s	Latches the effect on. Hold it longer and it plays only while held.
Hold a scene key	0.6 s	Stores the scene. A tap recalls it.
FX, **FX**	within 0.35 s	The settings of the effect you used last.
HOME, **HOME**	within 0.45 s	The visualizers.
OCT- + **OCT+**	5 s	Update mode.

Holding **OCT-** and **OCT+** while you **switch the FM-1 on** does something else: it calibrates the hardware (section 18).

4 THE SCREEN



The Tempo page



A breakdown

Top left. The piece's tag: its number, with a letter for the genre (`01` for HYPNO, `L03`, `H07`, `D02`, `V01` for dub, `N05` for DnB, `B04`, `G09`, `E06`, `T10`, `S03`, `F01`, `R07`, `W01`, `A05`, `P02` for the others). A mark in the tag means the piece has changes you haven't stored. Next to the tag are the root and the mode.

Top right. The slinky mascot. It hops on the kick, squashes on the snare, jumps on the drop, sleeps in a breakdown and shakes in a build. Next to it is the tempo. It says `EXT` while an outside MIDI clock (another device sending its tempo over MIDI) drives it, and shows a play triangle beside it while stopped. To the left of those, marks show what's on:

MARK	MEANS
BREAK, BUILD	The section playing. `BREAK>`, `BUILD>` or `DROP>` means one is waiting for the next bar. In a build, `DROP 3` counts the bars to the drop. With the auto-DJ, `BREAK IN 4` shows in the last bars of a groove, and `BREAK 2` in a breakdown counts the bars to its build.
KNOB	An FX knob isn't at its home position. If the sound is unexpectedly filtered, this is why.
KEY	The drop's key change is on.
S1> to S4>	A scene is waiting for the next bar.
DJ	The auto-DJ is running.
FX	Effects are latched on and the menu is closed. The **FX** button blinks too.
a small dot	Something is waiting to be saved to memory (the theme, Tune, MIDI out, a piece).

Left. The levels of the pad (P), bass (D), acid (A), pluck (C, for counter-melody) and kit (K).

Middle: the sigil. A circle that shows the harmony.

- The twelve notes sit around it, with the chord's root always at the top. Scale notes are lit, chord notes bright.
- The chord's notes are joined into a shape: a triad (three-note chord) is a triangle, a seventh chord a four-sided shape. You learn a chord's kind by its shape. Its name is under the eye.
- When the chord changes, the circle turns by the distance from the old root to the new one.
- Outside it, a ring fills over each 4-bar phrase. Outside that are the bar's 16 steps: the kick's are larger, the acid's are tinted, the playhead is white.
- Behind it, a pentagram turns once every 16 bars, and runes flare by the notes the pluck plays.
- In the middle is a demon eye. In a groove it's half open: the pupil widens on the kick and the gaze flips on the snare. It shuts in a breakdown. In a build it opens wide and trembles, and the phrase ring breaks into spinning gaps. The drop brings a white flash and a shock ring. **SEL** + **HOME** puts the slinky imp there instead (kept after power-off).
- At the top right, a bar fills towards the next chord change, or says `held` while frozen.
- When the FM-1 is working hard, it stops drawing the pentagram and runes first.

Right. The drum pattern playing, each lane in its own colour, and its number (`PAT 1`). When another pattern is waiting, `> 3`. Under it is the load readout, which shows how hard the FM-1 is working: `CPU 41 XR 0`, and below it `C2 38` and `S1` or `S2` when they apply. Section 16 explains them.

The line above the knobs. On the left, the sound of the voice on screen (on the drum pages, the kit). After it comes `BY HAND` when you're playing the voice yourself, `+LINK` or `LINKS OFF`, and the octave when it isn't at home (`OCT+2` for the page's voice, `SONG-1` for the whole song). On Global this line says what **SAVE** will do: `01 SAVE: STORE`, `01 STORED` or `01 FACTORY`. On the right are the page's name and the page dots, one dot per page (32 on the SELECT dial). The page you're on is bright, and the other pages in its group are dimmer. In the FX menu the dots are the four banks. Inside an effect's settings they're the 22 settings pages.

Bottom. The four knobs. Each shows its value's name, a ring (or pips, for a switch with only a few positions) and the value. The knob you turned last lights up for a moment.

Pictures. Pages that shape a sound draw it: the envelopes and LFOs, the filter's response, the echo and reverb tails, the compressor's curve. The picture follows the knobs as you turn them, with a dot running along it. It shows the shape, not exact milliseconds.

Messages. Short messages take the place of the header for a moment, such as `PATTERN 3 NEXT BAR`, `STORING` or `KEY CHANGE +5`.

5 THE PAGES

Turn **SELECT** to move through the pages in this order. There are 33, and the dial stops at each end. The voice buttons jump straight to a voice. Pressing the same button again steps through that voice's envelope and LFO pages (and, for the pad, the chords and the progression). On a voice's main page, **KNOB1** is its level. The a to d columns are **KNOB1** to **KNOB4**.

PAGE	REACH IT	A	B	C	D
Tempo	**HOME**	Tempo (70-190)	Evolve	Motion	Drift (how long a chord lasts: 1-32 bars in a genre, 20 s to 5 min in HYPNO; hold **SEL** and turn it for bars or seconds)
Pad	**ENV**	Level	Bright	Sound (24)	Detune
Pad env	**ENV** x2	Attack (0.05-10 s)	Hold (0-8 s)	Release (0.1-12 s)	Rest (0-6 s)
Pad LFO	**ENV** x3	Rate (a 1/4 note to 32 bars, then 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16, 1/16T)	Depth	Shape (sine, triangle, saw, square, S&H, drift)	Target (filter, level, pan, pitch; or another voice or effect: acid cut, acid reso, echo time, punch cut)
Chords	**ENV** x4	Chord (Auto, Triads, 7ths, 9ths, Sus, Dub, Fourths)	Voicing (close, open)	Chorus (0-100)	Loop (off, or repeat the last 2, 4 or 8 chords. With a ~, now and then one chord is picked anew.)
Progression	**ENV** x5, or hold **EDIT**	Chord (a chord of the scale, or Hold)	Type (Piece's, Triad, 7th, 9th, Sus, Dub, Fourths, 11th)	Bars (1, 2, 4, 8)	Play (Walk, Loop)
Bass	**LFO**	Level	Sound (24)	Cutoff	Reso
Bass env	**LFO** x2	Trigger (each chord, every 1, 2, 4 or 8 bars, or off)	Attack (0.01-4 s)	Decay (0.05-16 s)	Amount
Bass LFO	**LFO** x3	Rate (a 1/4 note to 32 bars, then 1/8, 1/8T, 1/16, 1/16T for a fast wobble)	Depth	Shape (as the pad's)	Target (cutoff, pitch, level, drive, reso; or acid cut, acid reso, echo time)

PAGE	REACH IT	A	B	C	D
Bass line	**LFO** x4	Mode (hold, root, kick, eighths, off-beat, walk, riff, nine named figures, and Steps)	Length (how long each note holds)	Move (octaves, fifths, approach notes)	Glide
Bass steps	**LFO** x5	Step (pick one with a white key: rest, note, accent, glide, accent + glide)	Note (root, 2nd .. 7th, octave: scale steps above the chord's root)	Octave (down, mid, up)	Mode (Steps plays them)
Acid	**ARP**	Level	Cutoff	Reso	Env mod
Acid env	**ARP** x2	Decay	Accent	Slide	Sound (31)
Acid line	**ARP** x3	Density	Length (1-16)	Range (1-3 octaves)	Mutate (hold **SEL** and turn to choose what a mutation changes: all, notes, rhythm or accents)
Acid answer	**ARP** x4	Answer (off, octave, fifth, third, mirror, reverse, rotate, sparse, accents)	Every (the 2nd to the 8th time round the line, or Drift: the bar before the drums change)	Direction (down 2, down, same, up, up 2)	Sync (bar, or the whole loop)
Acid steps	**ARP** x5	Step (pick one with a white key: rest, note, accent, slide, accent + slide)	Note (0-11 scale steps above the chord)	Octave (0-3)	Frozen (free, frozen)
Pluck	**ARP** x6	Level	Sound (12 + 30 DX7 + yours)	Density	Octave (-2 to +2)
Pluck 2	**ARP** x7	Decay	Style (up, down, up-down, random, skip, thirds)	Rate (1/4, 3/16, 1/8, 1/16, slow to fast)	Range (1-3 octaves)

PAGE	REACH IT	A	B	C	D
Deja vu	**ARP** x8	Pluck vu (0 always new notes, 100 locked)	Loop (4, 8, 16, 32 notes)	Leaps (notes jumping an octave)	Motif (0 off to 100: how often a bar reworks the phrase's first bar)
Pluck steps	**ARP** x9	Step (pick a step with a white key: rest, soft, note, accent)	Note (1-12: the chord's notes, low to high)	Octave (the pluck's, -2 to +2)	Frozen (free, frozen)
Drums	**SEQ**	Level	Drive	Swing (50-75 %)	Pattern (1-6, changes on the bar)
Links	**SEQ** x2	K>Bass	S>Pad	H>Acid	P>Clock (off, clock)
Kit	**SEQ** x3	Kick	Snare (and clap)	Hats (closed and open)	Perc
Drum drift	**SEQ** x4	Change (off, next, random; off lets the Settings page's Form decide)	Every (each chord, or 4-64 bars)	Pool (patterns 1-2 up to 1-6)	Mutate (off, shift, morph)
Groove	**SEQ** x5	Lane (kick to perc)	Density (0-100; 50 plays as written)	Source (follow, or pattern 1-6)	All dens (every lane's density at once)
Steps	**SEQ** x6	Lane	Ratchet (off, x2, x3, x4, x6, flam, swell 3, swell 4)	Push (0-7 twelfths of a step late)	Level (normal, ghost, soft, accent)
Feel	**SEQ** x7	Ghosts (0-100)	Accents (0-100; 50 as marked)	Pad comp (auto, hold, 7 rhythms)	Humanize (0-100)
Phrase	**SEQ** x8	Chain (off, or 9 chains of patterns)	Slice (off, 8 reorderings, auto)	Time (normal, half, double)	Cond (for the chosen lane: always, 1:2 ...)
Space	**SELECT**	Echo	Echo time (1/8, 3/16, 1/4, dotted 1/4, 1/2, 1 bar)	Reverb	Size

PAGE	REACH IT	A	B	C	D
Reverb	**SELECT**	Type (plate, shimmer, gated)	Damping	Predelay (6-30 ms)	Amount
Comp/Limit	**SELECT**	Ratio (off to 10:1)	Thresh (-30 to 0 dB)	Make-up (0 to +12 dB)	Ceiling (-12 to 0 dB)
Mixer	**SELECT**	Track (pad, bass, acid, pluck, drums)	Level	Pan (L100, C, R100)	Send (0-100)
Global	**GLO**	Root	Theme (6)	Tune (+-50 cents)	Genre (the bank, the same as **GLO** + **PRESETS**)
Set list	**GLO** x2	Slot (1-16; or a white key)	Genre (or Empty)	Piece (01-10)	Play (off, on)
Jam	**SELECT**	Voice (pluck, pad, acid, bass)	Keys (scale, chords, harp)	Octave (-2 to +2)	Answer (off, on)

Words on these pages:

- An **envelope** (env) shapes how a sound starts and fades each time it plays.
- An **LFO** is a slow wobble that moves the Target up and down. S&H jumps to a random value each cycle. Either LFO can also move another voice or an effect, stored with the piece: **Acid cut** and **Acid reso** give the acid a wah or a wobble of its own; **Echo time** wobbles the tape echo (a dub siren at full depth); the pad LFO's **Punch cut** sweeps the punch-in FILTER while you hold it (an auto-wah on the tracks it takes); the bass LFO's **Reso** moves the bass's resonance. The rates from 1/8 on lock it to the beat.
- **Cutoff** is where the filter starts cutting the highs (lower is darker). **Reso** (resonance) adds a squelchy peak there. **Env mod** is how far the acid's envelope opens the filter on each note.
- An **accent** is a louder note. A **slide** or **glide** bends smoothly into the next note.
- **Swing** plays every second sixteenth a little late. 50 % is straight.
- A **ratchet** is a step that plays as a quick roll. A flam is two hits very close together.
- **Ghosts** are very quiet hits between the main ones.
- **Send** is how much of a track goes to the echo and reverb. A **cent** is a hundredth of a semitone.

Three more screens are off the dial: the **Sequencer** (hold **SEQ**; section 8), the **Perform** screen (**HOME** again from Tempo; section 10) and the **visualizers** (**HOME**

twice quickly; section 13). On the Perform screen and the visualizers, the four knobs are the FX knobs: Filter, Crush, Throw and Wash (section 9).

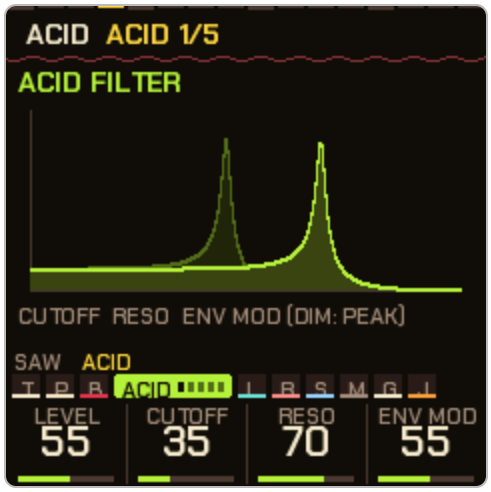
For a bed of noise, use the **Vinyl** effect (section 9). The Mixer page sits between Comp/Limit (the master bus) and Global.



The Pad page



The Pad env page draws its envelope



The Acid page draws the filter



The Chords page

What moves by itself

The chord changes on a bar line every few bars. How often depends on the genre:

BARS PER CHORD	GENRES
2	house, disco, garage, lofi, reggae, synthwave
4	dub, DnB, breaks, electro, trap, funk, amapiano, trip-hop
8	dubstep

Drift on the Tempo page changes that pace. Below 20 the chords change four times as often, below 45 twice as often. Above 80 they last twice as long, above 95 four times as long. The Tempo page shows the result in bars. In HYPNO a chord lasts for a time instead: Drift sets 20 seconds to 5 minutes, a little random, and the change waits for the next bar line. In any genre, **EDIT** moves on to the next chord.

You can switch any piece between the two. Hold **SEL** and turn Drift right for bars, left for seconds. HYPNO in bars starts from four bars a chord, and the other genres in seconds work as HYPNO does. The setting is stored with the piece, and the genres keep their own unless you change it.

On a seven-note scale, each genre has its own habits for which chord comes next:

- Lofi and DnB love to move up a fourth (the ii-V-I turnaround of jazz).
- House loops by steps and thirds.
- Dubstep and trap stay close to the home chord, on the dark side.
- Dub keeps to a minor vamp between the first and fourth chords.
- HYPNO keeps its original walk.

Lofi, DnB, breaks, garage, disco, reggae and amapiano use cadences (a strong pull back home). In a minor key their V chord (built on the scale's fifth note) raises the scale's seventh note a semitone, as in the harmonic minor. That note is the V chord's third, and the acid and bass raise it too. Diminished chords (the tense chord on the seventh note of a major key, the second of a minor one) are rare in every genre. Where a genre would lead home through one, it goes through V instead.

The **Loop** setting on the Chords page repeats the last 2, 4 or 8 chords, counted back from the chord playing now. So a loop of two is the home chord and one other. Picking a new piece empties the loop. Most genres come with one: four chords in house, disco, garage, trap and synthwave, two in dubstep, DnB, electro, amapiano and trip-hop. Lofi (for its turnarounds), dub, funk, reggae and breaks keep walking.

The voices follow the chords. The pad's notes swell and fade on cycles of different lengths, and each note takes the new chord's pitch as it swells back in. The bass follows the chord's root and glides. The acid line's notes are tied to the chord, so the riff moves with it. **Mutate** rewrites some of its steps each time round. The pluck plays an arpeggio, the chord's notes one after another. **Motion** sets how far the music slowly swings between sparse and full, over a minute or two. **Evolve** makes the acid and the chords more restless.

Tempo. Tempo runs from 70 to 190. To set it from any page, hold **HOME** and turn **SELECT**. To tap it in, hold **GLO** and tap `E4` four times or so. When an outside MIDI clock drives PERF-1, it follows that clock and the screen says `EXT`.

Octaves

OCT- and **OCT+** move an octave at a time, from three down to three up.

- On the Pad, Bass or Acid pages (or their env and LFO pages), they move that voice alone.
- On the Pluck pages they move the pluck, from two down to two up.
- On any other page, Tempo included, they move the whole song: pad, bass and acid together.

The line above the knobs shows the octave when it isn't at home: `OCT+2` for the page's voice, `SONG-1` for the song. Octaves are stored with the piece. Going down, each voice stops at the lowest note you can hear (about C1), so -2 and -3 may sound the same.

Chords

The pad's chords are built on the notes of the scale. How long each lasts is set as above (the genre's pace and Drift, or **EDIT**). The **Chords** page (**ENV** four times) sets what kind of chord it plays:

CHORD	WHAT IT PLAYS
Auto	Seventh chords on a 7-note scale (Am7, CM7, G7 ...), triads on a pentatonic (5-note) scale
Triads	Three notes: Am, C, G
7ths	Four notes: Am7, Dm7, CM7. On a pentatonic scale too.
9ths	The 1st, 3rd, 7th and 9th, with the fifth left out (four notes): Am9, CM9, G9
Sus	The 1st, 4th, 5th and 7th: A7sus4 (CM7sus4 where the seventh is major; a sus2 where the fourth would be sharp, as on F in A minor). Open and unresolved.
Dub	The same minor 9 shape on every chord, whatever the scale says. These are the parallel chord stabs of dub techno.
Fourths	Notes stacked in fourths (shown as A4ths), an m11 sound. Deep, hollow and modal.

Filter types. The pad's saw sounds, the bass and the acid each run through a resonant filter, low-pass as standard. The **FILTERS** settings page (hold **HOME**, then turn **SELECT** past MIDI IN) changes each one's type:

TYPE	SOUNDS LIKE
Low	As before: the top rolled off, Cutoff closes it down.
High	The bottom taken away: thin, airy, good for a build or a lead that cuts through.
Band	Only a band around the cutoff: nasal, telephone-like, great with resonance.
Notch	A gap at the cutoff: hollow and phasey as the cutoff moves.
Peak	The cutoff's band boosted against the rest: a vowel-like bite.

Making it scream. The **SCREAM** settings page (the next one after FILTERS) pushes the acid's and the bass's filters into the raw, screaming sound of an acid line through a distortion pedal. It is for all pieces (it is kept with the settings, not with a piece), and at 0 everything sounds as it did:

KNOB	WHAT IT DOES
Drive	Pushes the sound harder into the filter and saturates it: thicker, louder, rawer.
Scream	Takes the resonance far past Reso's top, towards the filter singing on its own. With Reso high and Cutoff moving, this is the scream.
Wow	Accented notes open the resonance and the drive further: the acid's wow on the accents.
Target	Which voice: the acid, the bass, or both.

Start with Scream at 60 and Drive at 40 on an acid piece, then turn the acid's Cutoff and Env mod (or let an LFO on **Acid cut** do it). Turn the acid's level down a little if it gets too loud: the limiter will hold it, but it squashes the rest of the mix.

The bass's LFO moving the cutoff (a wobble) works with every type. The setting is for every piece, kept with the settings. It's the MultiFilter idea from Caustic, rebuilt here.

Voicing sets how the chord is spread. Close keeps the four notes together. Open drops the second-highest note an octave, spreading the chord out. **Chorus** makes the pad sound wider, like several players at once, without an obvious pulsing. 0 is off. The genres set it between 20 and 50. The page also has **Root**, the same as on Global.

For dub techno, set Chord to Dub, pick the pad's Dub sound (dark chord stabs) and turn the echo up. HYPNO piece 06 is set up that way.

Your own progression



The Progression page

The **Progression** page lets you write the chords yourself. Hold **EDIT** to open it, or press **ENV** five times. A tap of **EDIT** still moves on to the next chord.

The page has eight slots. Each slot is one chord of the scale, its type and how many bars it lasts. The first eight white keys pick the slot you're editing. Until you change something, the page shows the chords you just heard, so you can start from those.

KNOB	DOES
Chord	The slot's chord, picked from the chords of the scale. The page shows each as a numeral (I to VII, small for a minor chord) and its name, like Am7. **Hold** leaves the slot empty: the chord before keeps playing for its bars.
Type	The kind of chord this slot plays. **Piece's** follows the Chord setting on the Pad's Chords page, like every slot did before. The others give the slot its own: **Triad** (three notes), **7th**, **9th**, **Sus** (the third swapped for the fourth), **Dub** (a minor ninth stab), **Fourths** (stacked fourths) or **11th** (root, seventh, ninth and eleventh). All of them use only notes of the scale.
Bars	How long the slot's chord lasts: 1, 2, 4 or 8 bars.
Play	**Walk**: the genre picks the chords, as usual. **Loop**: your slots play in turn.

Turning Chord, Type or Bars switches Play to Loop. Your progression starts on the next bar, from slot 1. The loop ends at the last slot that has a chord, so a four-chord progression only needs slots 1 to 4. **EDIT** jumps to the next slot, and the drop of a build goes back to slot 1.

Fills. The **black keys** write a whole progression into the slots in one press. The first five are circle of fifths fills, one that moves round the circle of fifths: each chord a fifth below the one before, as the scale allows. That fall by a fifth is the strongest pull in harmony, the one that makes a progression sound like it's going home. The other

six are progressions that are everywhere in songs (from Steven's chord chart in the PERF-1 issues).

BLACK KEY	WRITES	IN C MAJOR	IN A MINOR
1 (F#)	ii V I I	Dm G C C	Bdim Em Am Am
2 (G#)	vi ii V I	Am Dm G C	F Bdim Em Am
3 (A#)	iii vi ii V I I	Em Am Dm G C C	C F Bdim Em Am Am
4 (C#)	I vi ii V (the turnaround)	C Am Dm G	Am F Bdim Em
5 (D#)	The whole circle: I IV vii iii vi ii V I	C F Bdim Em Am Dm G C	Am Dm G C F Bdim Em Am
6 (F#)	I IV V V	C F G G	Am Dm Em Em
7 (G#)	I I IV vi	C C F Am	Am Am Dm F
8 (A#)	I IV I V	C F C G	Am Dm Am Em
9 (C#)	I iii IV vi	C Em F Am	Am C Dm F
10 (D#)	I vi IV	C Am F	Am F Dm
11 (F#)	IV V IV I	F G F C	Dm Em Dm Am

Each chord gets the bars of the slot you had chosen, so choose a slot and set its Bars first; the slots after the fill are emptied, and Play goes to Loop. The types you gave the slots stay. The chords stay in the scale, so in a minor key the V is minor (v), unless the genre raises it for the cadence (the THEORY screen shows that G# in red). It's stored with the piece like any progression. A pentatonic scale has no circle to walk, so the fills are off there. The black keys blink faintly on this page to show they do something; watch the THEORY screen while it plays and you see the progression walk round the circle.

Pedal: follow the chords, or hold the key. White key 9 switches the **bass** and **white key 10** the **pad** between two ways of playing:

- **Follows** (as always): the voice moves with each chord.
- **Pedal**: the voice stays on the key while the chords move above it. The bass holds the key's root (a walking bass walks the key's own chord), and the pad holds the key's chord (Am7 in A minor) as the progression goes round. This is a pedal point, the oldest drone trick there is: the music gets tension as the chords pull away from the held note, and it all comes home when they return to I. Good for playing a guitar or a synth over it.

The keys are lit while a voice is on Pedal, and the bottom of the page says which. It's your setting, not the piece's: it stays as you leave it, across pieces and power-off. The THEORY screen still shows the chords as they move.

The chords are steps of the scale, not fixed notes, so they follow the key. Change the root or the mode and the progression moves with it. The chord kind, the voicing and the rest of the Chords page still apply. In the genres with a cadence, the V chord in a minor key gets its raised seventh, as it does in the walk.

While Play is on Loop, the walk, Drift and the chord Loop setting have no say. Set Play back to Walk and the genre takes over again, with your slots kept for later. The progression is stored with the piece.

6 PIECES, GENRES AND STORING



Storing a piece on Global

PERF-1 has nineteen **genres**. Each is a bank of ten **pieces**, ready-made songs to play and change.

- Turn **PRESETS** for another piece in the bank. It goes from 01 to 10 and wraps round.
- Hold **GLO** and turn **PRESETS** for another bank (it wraps round too), or use the Genre knob on the Global page.

When you change genre, the same piece number keeps playing in the new genre, and the genre's own effects come on with it. For example, lofi latches vinyl and tape on, and house latches the pump on (the pump ducks the music on each kick, so it seems to breathe with the beat). Changing genre first clears any vinyl, tape, pump or phaser you had latched.

Each piece has its own settings, its own six drum patterns and its own drum sounds. Patterns 1 to 6 run roughly: intro, groove, build, peak, variation, and a thinner one to mix with. When you pick a piece it shows a made-up title, such as `VELVET RAIN`, the same one every time.

GENRE	PIECES	BPM	WHAT IT IS
HYPNO	01-10	118-138	The original hypnotic techno and acid set.
LOFI	L01-L10	70-94	Swung boom-bap. Rhodes chords in 7ths and 9ths over a warm bass, a soft sparse lead, the Dusty kit. Vinyl and tape latched on.
HOUSE	H01-H10	118-126	Four on the floor, claps on 2 and 4, open hats on the off-beats, stabs and organ, a sub or square bass, the House kit. The pump latched on.
DUBSTEP	D01-D10	136-150	Half time, the Heavy kit, a wobble bass (its LFO moves the cutoff), a harsh lead, dark pads, chords in fourths. After a drop: 8 bars half time with the wobble changing speed each bar, then 8 bars at full time, then half time again. 8-bar builds that end in 32nds and triplets.
DUB	V01-V10	64-76	One-drop, steppers and rockers rhythms. A sparse kick and rim, a deep bass on beats one and three, the off-beat chord chops (the skank), a long dotted echo and worn tape latched on. A breakdown is a dub-out: the drums and the bass line go on, the rest falls away.
DNB	N01-N10	170-178	Two-step, liquid, roller, neuro, jump-up and half-time. The DnB kit, a shimmer reverb, a light pump and tape.
BREAKS	B01-B10	100-135	Patterns after classic breaks (Funky Drummer, Impeach, Levee, Cold Sweat) and a big-beat stomp. Some are approximations. The Break kit, a gated reverb, tape and the phaser latched on.
GARAGE	G01-G10	126-138	Swung two-step, skippy beats and speed garage. A conga kick, rim shots that call and answer, the Minimal snare and House hats. Tape and a light pump.
ELECTRO	E01-E10	118-130	A syncopated kick, the clap on the backbeat, the Electro kit, a gated reverb. The phaser latched on.
TRAP	T01-T10	130-150	The long 808 bass (the Trap kit), the clap on beat 3, hats in 16ths with rolls (two per piece), an open hat and a rim. Fills roll the hats in 32nds and triplets. A shimmer reverb, and a pump under the 808.
DISCO	S01-S10	112-126	Four on the floor, accented open hats on the off-beats, a bass bouncing in octaves, strings and brass stabs, Wurli and clav, a little swing.
FUNK	F01-F10	96-110	Syncopated sixteenths, ghost snares and soft kick pickups, a funk bass figure, a clav line, sixteenth-note chords, the Dusty and 909 kicks. A breakdown is the drums alone.

GENRE	PIECES	BPM	WHAT IT IS
REGGAE	R01-R10	70-84	One-drop, steppers and rockers, the rim a touch late, a melodic bass, an off-beat skank, a long echo, the Dusty kit.
SYNTHWAVE	W01-W10	100-118	A driving eighth-note bass, a gated reverb, a big accented snare, lots of chorus, an arpeggiating acid. The minor pieces circle i-VI-III-VII; the major ones play the decade's I-vi-IV-V. (On the screen: SYNTHWV.)
AMAPIANO	A01-A10	108-115	A soft kick with shakers, a gliding syncopated bass (playing the log drum's part), jazzy 9ths, marimba and kalimba plucks. (On the screen: AMAPI.)
TRIPHOP	P01-P10	70-88	Slow and dusty, the snare laid back, ghost notes, vinyl noise, a pluck loop that comes round again, minor and sparse.
INDUS	I01-I10	118-145	Industrial techno, EBM and industrial breakbeat. Driven, harsh drums tuned against each other (the snare a tritone up, the perc a semitone off), the Hard kit with the Break kit's chops in some pieces, broken and off-beat kicks, an EBM stomp, perc in threes against the beat. Phrygian and minor, suspended and fourths chords, a grinding bass, metal and bell sounds, a gated reverb and hard tape. Fills roll on the off-beats and in triplets.
PSY	Y01-Y10	92-146	Psytrance: progressive, full-on and goa (132-146), the kick on every beat with the rolling bass between (K-B-B-B), soft 16th hats, the open hat off the beat, the acid as the squelching lead, a dotted (3/16) echo, phrygian and minor, a chord held for 8 bars. Y01, Y02 and Y10 are psy-ambient and psychill (92-112): a downtempo beat, a held bass, a wide shimmer reverb. With the set list and the SET page's Mix you can go from the cosmic into the trance and back.
FOREST	O01-O10	148-165	Dark forest and dark psy: the same rolling bass under every-16th hats and a glitching percussion in threes against the four, hat rolls, triplets, the Hard kit, phrygian and fourths, the chord barely moving.

The sections follow each genre's habits too. House, dubstep, DnB, trap, disco and synthwave cut everything for the last beat before the drop. Lofi, dub, reggae, amapiano and trip-hop build on the perc instead of a snare roll. Breaks and funk break down to the drums alone. Each genre has its own fills: house and disco ramp and rush, dub and reggae drag, trap and dubstep roll in triplets, garage rolls its rim, and disco, funk and synthwave play a falling tom. In HYPNO the kick drops out for the last beat of every eighth bar.

Pieces in the same genre differ in sound as well as in key and tempo. Each genre has a set of sounds for the pad, bass, acid, pluck and kits, and each piece takes one of

each, picked by its number. The pluck's sound, style and rate change from piece to piece in every genre. Each genre also has its own compressor settings (section 11).

Disco, funk, reggae, synthwave, amapiano and trip-hop use the same drum kits as the other genres.

Storing a piece

This works in every genre. Go to **Global** and press **SAVE**. The piece is stored as it is: every page's values, the scale and mode, the voices' sounds and kit, the patterns and the drum sounds. It's stored in the genre you're in and takes the place of that genre's factory piece: store piece 3 of lofi, and piece 3 of lofi is yours from then on. Each genre has its own place in memory. The line above the knobs says `01 SAVE: STORE` while the piece has changes, then `01 STORED`.

Changes you don't store last while you stay in that genre, even if you move between its pieces. They're gone when you change genre or switch off, and the genre's pieces come back as they were when you return.

Back to factory. On Global, hold **SEL** and **SAVE** together for 1.5 seconds. The screen says `KEEP HOLDING: FACTORY` while you hold. The piece goes back to how it shipped, and its slot goes back to the factory piece. **SAVE** alone only stores.

When it's written. Straight away. The FM-1 can't make sound while it writes to its memory. So if the music is playing, it fades out (the screen says `STORING`), writes, and fades back in exactly where it was. The pause is a fraction of a second, and the song stays in time with itself. MIDI clock out pauses with it. Factory works the same way, and so does anything else PERF-1 saves (section 13).

At power-on PERF-1 always starts in HYPNO, on a random piece. If you stored that piece, it plays as you stored it. If you didn't, it plays the factory piece with small random changes.

HYPNO PIECE	CHARACTER	BPM	KEY
01	Hypnotic four on the floor	128	A Aeolian
02	Deep and dubby, with rims and shakers	124	D Dorian
03	Pounding, with a rumble kick and claps	132	E Phrygian
04	Trance, with off-beat open hats and rolls	138	G Aeolian
05	Acid electro, with cowbells and breaks	130	A Dorian
06	Dub techno: chord stabs (Dub chords), sparse, swung	120	F Pent minor
07	Minimal glitch, with patterns in threes over the four beats	134	B Pent major
08	Rolling, tom-like percussion	126	Bb Mixolydian
09	Warehouse: hard, with rides and rumble (the Techno kit)	136	C Phrygian
10	Deep field, with half time and breaks	118	Eb Aeolian

7 SOUNDS, KITS AND PLAYING

Each voice has its own list of sounds, and each drum can take its sound from any of fourteen kits. The sounds you pick are stored with the piece.

To change a voice's sound, turn the **Sound** knob on its page, or hold **SEL** and turn **ALGORITHM** on any of its pages. On the pluck pages, SEL + ALGORITHM skips to the next sound that's actually there and wraps round from the last to the first. The voice keeps its notes, envelope, LFO and filter. Only the sound changes.

A few words used below. **FM** is the way the DX7 and the FM-1 make sound: one tone bends another, which is good for bells, electric pianos and metallic sounds. A **saw** is the buzzy waveform behind most analog synth sounds. **Detuned** means a few copies of a sound slightly out of tune with each other, which makes it wider. A **sub** is an extra tone an octave below. A **filter** cuts the high end of a sound. Opening it makes the sound brighter.

The pad: 24 sounds

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
1	Rhodes	An FM electric piano that gets brighter as it swells
2	Voices	A sung choir
3	Strings	Four detuned saws. The Detune knob spreads them.
4	Glass	An FM bell
5	Organ	A drawbar organ
6	Warm	Soft triangle waves
7	Stabs	Short Rhodes chords on the off-beats. Release on the Pad env page sets their length. Evolve adds a few more.
8	Dark	The Voices, muffled
9	Dub	Short, dark saw chords for dub techno
10	Trance	A supersaw: four detuned saws plus one an octave up
11	Poly	Two detuned saws with a slowly drifting pulse, like an 80s polysynth
12	Hollow	A hollow tone, like a clarinet
13	Pings	The Glass bells as short stabs
14	Hits	A house organ as stabs
15	Rave	Supersaw stabs
16	Sine	A pure tone, for minimal
17	Ooh	The Voices, darker and rounder
18	Wurli	A bright electric piano, played as stabs
19	Mallet	Marimba and vibes chords as stabs, a softer FM sound
20	Brass	Saw chords as stabs, with the filter wide open
21	Fat	A supersaw with the top end cut
22	Pluck	The Poly sound as short stabs
23	Chapel	A church organ (drawbars with the top end cut)

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
24	Air	An open sine, like breath

The saw sounds (Strings, Dub, Trance, Poly, Rave, Brass, Fat and Pluck) go through an analog-style filter with a sub an octave below them. The filter is a four-pole low-pass with resonance, which means a strong cut of the high end with a peak where it cuts. It opens with each swell or stab and closes after it. **Bright** opens it further, and the Pad LFO with its Target on Filter sweeps it.

The bass: 24 sounds

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
1	Saws	Three saws, slightly detuned
2	Warm	Rounder, with more sub
3	Grit	Overdriven
4	Dirty	A distorted sub
5	Reese	Two saws far out of tune, so they phase against each other
6	Pulse	A pulse wave whose width wanders
7	FM	An FM bass that the envelope opens up
8	Organ	A drawbar organ
9	Rumble	A driven sub with the saws far back, for techno rumble
10	Sub	A sine with a sub under it
11	Square	Hollow, for deep house
12	Hoover	Detuned pulses plus an octave down
13	Fifths	The root and its fifth, a dub chord
14	Metal	Clangy FM
15	Sync	A saw with hard sync (one oscillator restarting another, for a tearing sound), swept by the envelope
16	Bright	The Saws with the filter open
17	Wub	A hard-driven sub with the filter low, the body of a dubstep wobble
18	Bite	A biting FM bass that the envelope opens up
19	Tine	An electric piano's low end
20	Clang	Even more clangy FM than Metal
21	Gnarl	The Reese, driven hard
22	Wide	A softer Hoover with more sub
23	Power	The root and its fifth, driven

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
24	Air	A soft, open sine

The bass as a line



The Bass line page

Want the bass to play a rhythm instead of one long note? Use the **Bass line** page (press **LFO** four times). It turns the bass into a line that follows the chord. **Mode** picks where the notes fall.

In the figures below, 1 2 3 4 are the beats, "and" is the eighth between two beats, and "e" and "a" are the sixteenths either side of the "and". So "and-of-2" is halfway between beats 2 and 3.

MODE	WHERE THE NOTES FALL
Hold	No line: one long note that glides to each chord's root
Root	On the genre's own bass rhythm (hypnotic on the beats, lofi a lazy three, DnB a roll, and so on)
Kick	On every kick, as an 808 or sub bass does
Eighths	On every eighth
Off-beat	On the off-beat eighths, as in house
Walk	On the beats: the root, then the third or fifth, then the fifth, then a lead-in to the next bar: the scale note just below the root, or half the time the note a half step below (a chromatic approach, the one passing note PERF-1 plays outside the scale)
Riff	On the genre's own figure. Disco bounces the octave, funk and amapiano syncopate, reggae leans on the fifth.
Octaves	Eighths bouncing between the root and its octave (disco)
Two-step	1, and-of-2, and-of-3 (garage, drum and bass)
One-drop	1, a-of-1, and-of-2, 3 (reggae)
Log drum	1, a-of-1, and-of-2, and-of-3, a-of-4 (amapiano)
Skippy	A skipping sub that jumps up to the fifth and the octave
Funk	1, a-of-1, 3, and-of-3
Big beat	1, e-of-2, 3, 4
Dub	1, 3, and-of-3
Gallop	Three sixteenths a beat
Steps	Your own sixteen steps, from the **Bass steps** page (below)

The named figures work in any genre. Each is a rhythm with up to four notes, so it sounds the same every bar. "The fifth" is the fifth above the root when the chord has one. A 9th, Dub or Fourths chord has no fifth among its first notes, so the line uses the chord's third note instead.

KNOB	DOES
Mode	Where the notes fall (the table above)
Length	How long each note holds before it lets go, from a quarter of a step to five steps
Move	How often a note jumps up an octave, to the fifth, or to the scale note below the root instead. In Walk, how often the last beat steps below.
Glide	The slide from one note to the next. 0 plays each note straight. 100 takes about 0.4 s.

Each note opens the bass's filter again, using the attack and decay from the **Bass env** page, so that page still shapes the sound. Its Trigger setting doesn't apply to a bass line. The sound, cutoff and resonance come from the **Bass** page. A breakdown plays no bass notes, and in Kick mode a build plays none either. When you play the bass by hand from the keys, the bass line stops. Every note stays between C1 and B5.

New pieces start with these bass lines:

GENRE	BASS LINE
Lofi, DnB, trip-hop	Root
House	Off-beat
Dubstep, trap	Kick, long notes, a little glide
Electro, synthwave	Eighths
Disco, funk, reggae, amapiano, breaks, garage	Riff
HYPNO, dub	Hold (the plain held bass)

Bass steps: write the bass line yourself

Want a bass line of your own? The **Bass steps** page (press **LFO** five times, after Bass line) gives the bass sixteen steps, one bar, like the Acid steps and Pluck steps pages. Open it and it already holds the bar the bass just played, so you can start from something that works and change what you like.

- Press a **white key** to pick a step (the sixteen white keys are the sixteen steps; the one you picked is lit).
- **Step** (KNOB1): rest, note, accent (louder), glide (slides into the note from the one before, without a new attack), or accent and glide.

- **Note** (KNOB2): the root, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 5th, 6th, 7th or octave, counted in the scale above the chord's root. The notes follow the chords: a 5th is always the fifth of the chord playing.
- **Octave** (KNOB3): down, mid or up.
- **Mode** (KNOB4): the bass line's mode. **Steps** plays your steps; any edit switches to it. Turn it back to try the other modes: your steps stay.

The steps belong to the piece: save it (**GLO**, then **SAVE**) to keep them, and a shared piece carries them. A piece without steps plays its own bass line.

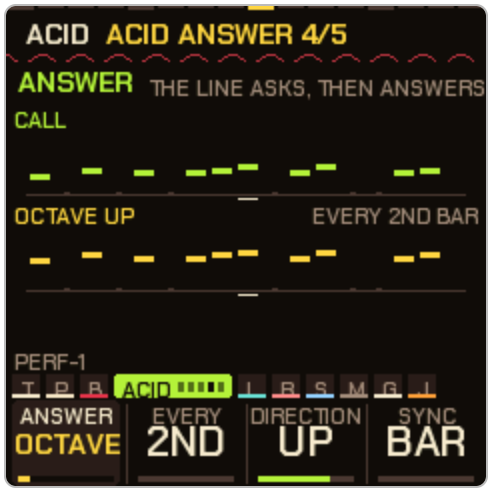
The acid: 31 sounds

The acid voice is modelled on the Roland TB-303, the small bass synth behind acid house.

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
1-2	Saw, Square	The 303's own two waveforms
3	Driven	Pushed hard and up front
4	Sync	Hard sync, swept by the envelope
5	Pluck	A plucked FM tone
6	PWM	A pulse wave whose width moves
7	Chip	A raw 8-bit square, like an old game console
8	Sub	With a square an octave below
9	Trance	Three detuned saws, for a trance arp
10	Bleep	A sine, the bleeps of early techno
11	Fifth	A saw plus its fifth, a rave stab
12	Bell	An FM bell that mellows as it rings
13	Organ	A house organ riff
14	Laser	The pitch drops with the envelope
15	Fold	A sine that folds over itself and gets buzzier as the envelope opens
16	Soft	A triangle, for quiet arps
17-24	Marimba, E.Piano, Kalimba, Brass, Gong, Clav, Vibes, Digital	FM instruments, each with its own character. Brass gets brighter as the note settles. Digital is a DX-style bell.
25	Super	Five saws spread wide (+-24 cents), a wall of trance lead
26	CZ	In the style of Casio's CZ synths: a smooth tone that bends into a saw as the envelope rises, with a resonant peak
27	Mini	An analog-style monosynth bass: two slightly detuned saws and a pulse an octave down
28	Hyper	Like Super, spread twice as wide
29	CZ Pulse	CZ-style, a hollow tone that turns into a buzz
30	CZ Bell	CZ-style, a bell tone that rings with the envelope

#	SOUND	WHAT IT IS
31	Lead	Two saws and a wandering pulse

The acid answer: call and response



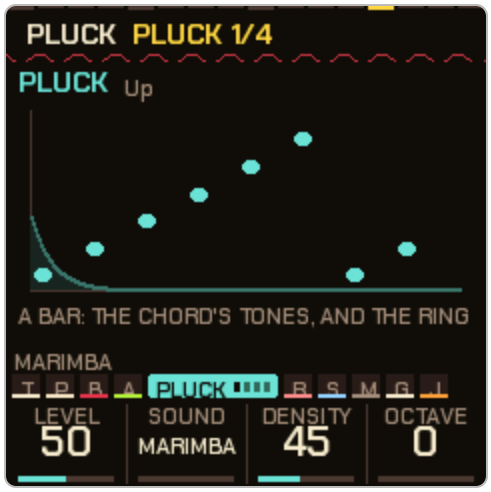
The Acid answer page

The **Acid answer** page (press **ARP** four times) makes the acid line ask and then answer. Every few bars it plays a changed version of itself. It's off by default, stored with the piece, and listed under Acid in the editor (section 15).

SETTING	DOES
Answer	How the line is changed. **Octave**. **Fifth** (seven semitones). **Third** (two notes up or down the scale, so it stays in key). **Mirror** (the line turned upside down around its own middle note, so it stays in the same range). **Reverse** (the line backwards). **Rotate** (the line shifted by a beat). **Sparse** (only the even steps). **Accents** (only the accented notes).
Every	How often the answer comes, from every 2nd to every 8th bar (or time round the line, see Sync). On 4th, you hear the call three times and the answer on the fourth. **Drift** brings the answer in the bar before the drums change pattern (Drum drift, section 10). If Drum drift isn't changing patterns, Drift falls back to every 8th.
Direction	Down 2, Down, Same, Up or Up 2. For Octave, Fifth and Third it moves the line by that interval once or twice. For the others it moves by octaves. If the answer would leave the acid's range (a low line answered downwards), it goes the other way instead, so it never lands back on the call.
Sync	What Every counts. **Bar**: the answer lasts one bar, so with a line of 12 or 10 steps it starts and ends partway through the line. **Loop**: the answer is the whole line, and Every counts times round it. With Drift, the answer is the loop that starts in the bar before the drums change. Use Loop for lines that aren't 16 steps long.

The page draws the call and its answer, one dot per step at the height of its note.

The pluck: 12 + 30 + up to 16 sounds



The Pluck page draws its decay and the line it plays over a bar

The pluck is the counter-melody, a second, lighter line over the rest. It plays an **arpeggio**: the chord's notes one after another rather than all at once. Two plucked voices take turns, so each note's tail rings on under the next. It plays in time with the bar, with swing on the off-sixteenths (swing makes every second note land a little late, for a shuffle), and it thins out in a breakdown.

It sits under the other parts by default (Level 50, Density 45). Turn Level to 0 to turn it off. Its two pages are **Pluck** and **Pluck 2**, on **ARP** (press it six and seven times). The mood (section 10) moves its level, decay and density.

SETTING	DOES
Style	The order of the notes: up, down, up-down, random, skip (every second chord note), or thirds
Rate	How fast: 1/4, 3/16 (a dotted eighth), 1/8 or 1/16
Range	How many octaves the arpeggio spans, 1-3
Decay	How long a note rings. For the DX sounds it sets how long the key is held down (0.12 s to 1.7 s), and the note fades out a while after the key comes up.

The pluck has three groups of sounds:

- **Plain (12):** Pluck, Marimba, E.Piano, Kalimba, Bell, Vibes, Gong, Clav, Digital, Brass, Bleep, Glass. All are FM except Bleep, which is a plain sine.

- **Built-in DX7 voices (30):** DX Tine EP, DX Glass Bell, DX Round Bass, DX Brass Sect, DX Soft Pad, DX Wood Bars, DX Drawbars, DX Nylon Pick, DX Brass 2, DX Solid Bass, DX Bells, DX Marimba, DX Clavinet, DX Strings, DX Glass Pad, DX Sync Lead, DX Harp, DX Kalimba, DX Flute, DX Steel Drum, DX Saw Bass, DX Tubular, and the eight described below. The DX7 is Yamaha's classic 1983 FM synth. These voices play just as they would on one: all 32 algorithms (the ways its six tone generators are wired together), the envelopes with their curves and scaling, velocity, LFO, pitch envelope and feedback. The pluck plays up to six notes at once. Heavy patches play fewer (the bells, brass, strings and pads three or four) to keep the load down.
- **Yours (up to 16):** DX7 voices you load yourself come after the built-in ones, named `DX` plus the voice's own name (section 15).

The last eight built-in DX voices are guitars, a bass and brass:

VOICE	WHAT IT IS
Steel Gtr	A strummed steel string with a long ring
Clean Gtr	An electric guitar that holds, with a little chorus
Muted Gtr	The funk "chank", over in a tenth of a second
Drive Gtr	A distorted guitar, held
Slap Bass	A slapped bass
Synth Brass	A swell, with the bite coming up
Sax	A reed with a vibrato that comes in late
Mute Trumpet	The thin, nasal sound of a muted trumpet

These eight are first drafts, written for PERF-1 and tuned by numbers rather than by ear. The disco, funk, reggae, synthwave, amapiano and trip-hop genres use them. Tell the maker what you think of them.

The DY set. On the Settings page, **Voices** chooses between two sets. **DY** (the default) swaps all thirty built-in voices for DX7 patches made by people, of the same kind, chosen by name from public-domain banks: Pafreak's SYNTHOXICATED banks, madFame's Custom Patches, the 1980s magazine banks on Bobby Blues' page, and one from Jack Deckard's collection on Dave Benson's page. **DX** puts the built-in set back. Each DY voice shows its bank's own name. For example, madFame's `MF EPRHOD1` stands in for the Tine EP and the Aftertouch magazine's `SAXOPHONE` for the Sax. The full list is in the PERF-1 source. The names on the screen change with

the switch. Each DY voice is set to the same loudness as the DX voice it replaces, so the genres' mix stays balanced.

For more sounds, load your own. The installer page takes any DX7 `.syx` bank or single voice (section 15), and there are large free collections, such as Bobby Blues' DX7 archive, Soundarchive and Yamaha Black Boxes. Each bank's licence is its author's. PERF-1 doesn't include any of them.

Pluck steps: freeze the pluck's loop and edit it



The Pluck steps page

Like a pluck phrase and want to keep it, or write your own? The **Pluck steps** page (press **ARP** nine times, after Deja vu) holds the pluck's loop and lets you edit it one step at a time.

The page is laid out like Acid steps. It shows one bar as sixteen steps, each drawn as a bar, and the height is the step's note. A note here is one of the chord's notes, counted from low to high across the pluck's octaves (1 is the lowest). Because the notes come from the chord playing, your line follows the harmony when the chord changes. An accent is drawn in the bright colour, a soft note dim, a rest as a dash, and a mark sits under the step that's playing.

1. Press a **white key** to choose a step.
2. Turn **Step** to set what it plays: Rest, Soft, Note or Accent.
3. Turn **Note** (1-12) to set its note.
4. **Octave** moves the whole pluck up or down (-2 to +2), the same as on the Pluck page. How many octaves the notes span is **Range**, on Pluck 2.

Frozen holds the line. Any edit freezes it. Freezing also sets Deja vu's Loop to 16, the pluck's Rate to 1/16 and Pluck vu to 100, so every note comes round the same each bar. A frozen line stays when you start a new piece, and it's **stored with the piece** (a

note and a kind for each step). Set Frozen back to Free and the loop belongs to Deja vu again, and a new piece forgets it.

With the Jam page's voice on the pluck, Capture (**SEL** + **REC**) writes the bar you just played into this page (section 10).

Acid steps: freeze the line and edit it



The Acid steps page

The acid line makes itself up as it goes, and Mutate rewrites a little of it each time round. To keep a line you like and shape it, use the **Acid steps** page (press **ARP** five times, after Acid answer).

The page draws the line as sixteen bars, one per step, the same way as Pluck steps. The height is the note, and a short tail means the step slides into the next. Press a **white key** to choose a step, then set it with the knobs:

KNOB	DOES
Step	**Rest**, **Note**, **Accent** (louder and brighter), **Slide** (glides into the next note, as on a 303) or **Acc+Slide**
Note	The note, 0 to 11 scale steps above the chord. The line follows the chord, so it moves when the chord changes.
Octave	0 to 3 octaves up, on top of the Acid octave
Frozen	**Free**: the line keeps changing (Mutate), and a new one grows with each piece. **Frozen**: the line holds as it is, Mutate leaves it alone, and it's **stored with the piece** (Global, SAVE) and comes back with it.

Any edit freezes the line, so Mutate can't rewrite it. Turn Frozen back to Free to let it change again. To keep the line you're hearing as it is, turn Frozen to Frozen. The line's Length, the answer (above) and the Acid octave all work on a frozen line as usual. Steps beyond the Length are drawn dim and don't play. A piece stored with older firmware starts with a free line.

Deja vu: loops in the pluck, and what the acid mutates



The Deja vu page

Left alone, the pluck picks every note fresh. The **Deja vu** page (press **ARP** eight times) makes it remember, so phrases come back.

KNOB	DOES
Pluck vu	Each time a note comes round again, the chance it's the same note, rest or leap as last time. 0: every note is new. 100: the loop is locked and repeats exactly.
Loop	How many notes it remembers: 4, 8, 16 or 32
Leaps	How often a new note jumps an octave
Motif	How often a bar develops the phrase's opening idea (0 off, 100 always; 60 by default)

A locked phrase is always played over the chord of the moment, so it follows the harmony. Changing the Loop length, or starting a new piece, forgets the loop.

Motif makes the pluck think in phrases. The first bar of every eight is kept as an idea: which sixteenths played and how far each note stepped up or down the chord from the one before. Each bar after it then develops the idea, as often as the knob says. It plays the same shape starting from wherever the line is (so it follows the chords), sometimes upside down, or with a new last step. The fifth bar plays the idea again at its first pitch, as an answer to the first bar. Most phrases start a new idea. Some open with the old one again. At 0, the pluck makes up every bar fresh. Deja vu wins over Motif: a note that Deja vu replays is replayed whatever the motif says.

The acid has its own version of this, **Mutate** on the Acid line page, which rewrites a few steps each time round. Hold **SEL** and turn the Mutate knob on that page to choose what a rewrite changes:

- **All:** anything.
- **Notes:** the rhythm stays and the notes drift, the classic acid move.
- **Rhythm:** the same notes come and go.
- **Accents:** only the accents and slides.

The kits: 14



The Kit page

Press **SEQ** three times for the Kit page. Each knob picks one drum's sound from the same fourteen kits: the kick, the snare (with the clap), the hats (closed and open) and the perc.

Some kits **duck** other parts: each kick briefly turns them down, which gives a pumping feel. Some **crush** the drums, adding a grainy, lo-fi grit. 808 and 909 are Roland's classic drum machines.

KIT	THE KICK	THE REST
Hypno	Deep	Metallic 808-style hats, a soft rim
House	Round	A wide clap, long open hats, congas
Techno	Hard, with a rumble tail	A tight clap, metal hats, a bell perc
Acid	Punchy, 909-style	A cowbell for the perc
Break	Distorted	A cracking snare, noisy hats, a tom. The Break kick also chops the drums up live (ghost snares, extra kicks, fast 32nd rolls, more with Evolve) and crushes them.
Minimal	Short and clicky	A rim for the snare, tight hats, a woodblock
Hard	Industrial, distorted, with a long rumble	A noisy snare, a metal clank. It crushes the drums a little.
808	A long boom	A snappy snare, a wide clap, a cowbell
Dusty	Soft and round, ducking the rest a little	A loose low snare, a muted clap, dull short hats, a soft rim (lofi)
Heavy	A deep sub kick with a long tail, ducking the bass hard	A big cracking snare, a wide clap, tight hats, a metal perc (dubstep)
909	Punchy, with a click	A snappy snare, a clap, ticking hats and long open ones, a tom
Electro	Short and high	A tight bright snare, a thin clap, glassy hats, a zappy tom
DnB	Tight	A loud cracking snare, a clap, fast tiny hats, a clicky perc
Trap	A long 808 sub with almost no click	A snare and a wide clap together, tiny hats, a bell

On any of the drums' pages, **SEL** + **ALGORITHM** switches all four to the next kit at once. Mix them freely. A Techno kick under House hats is fine.

Playing a voice by hand



Help card for the LFO button, which also says how to play the bass

Normally the keys set the scale. You can also take a voice away from the algorithm and play it yourself:

1. Go to any of the voice's pages: **ENV** for the pad, **LFO** for the bass, **ARP** for the acid.
2. Hold **SEL** and press **ENV**. The voice goes quiet and the line above the knobs says `BY HAND`. (On a page that isn't a voice's, SEL + ENV just tells you so.)
3. Play the keys. While that voice's pages are on screen (Pad, Pad env, Pad LFO or Chords; the bass's three pages; the acid's three pages), the keys play it over the rest of the song.

How each voice plays:

- **Pad:** up to four notes at once, each on one of its voices, with Attack and Release from the Pad env page (quicker than its own slow swells).
- **Bass:** the last key held, two octaves down. The envelope opens on each new press.
- **Acid:** the last key held, an octave down, with its filter and envelope. Press a second key while holding one and it slides to it, as a 303 does.

Everything else carries on by itself: the other voices, the chords and the drums. The keys follow the voice's octave and the song's (**OCT-** / **OCT+**), and the lit keys still show the scale, so you can see what's in key. It works while stopped too. A key keeps playing until you let go, even if you change page. On any other page (Tempo, Global and so on) the keys edit the scale as usual.

To give the voice back to the algorithm, press **SEL** + **ENV** on its pages again. Which voices are played by hand is stored with the piece. MIDI out sends what you play, on the voice's channel. The pluck is played on the **Jam** page instead (section 10).

Links: the drums into the voices



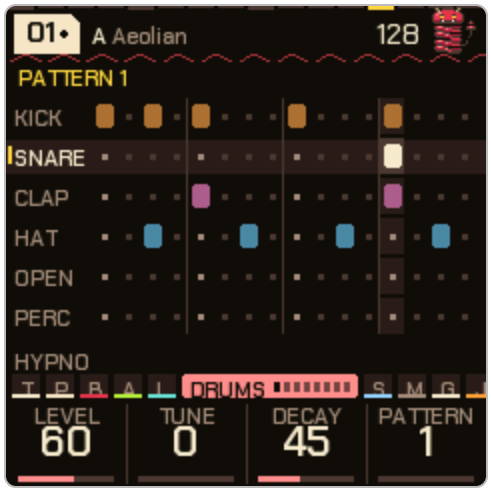
The Links page

Links let the drum hits push the voices around, like trigger cables on a modular synth. **SEL** + **SEQ** turns the links on and off without losing their settings, and `+LINK` shows on the line above the knobs while they're on. Set each one on the **Links** page (press **SEQ** twice). 0 means off. They're stored with the piece.

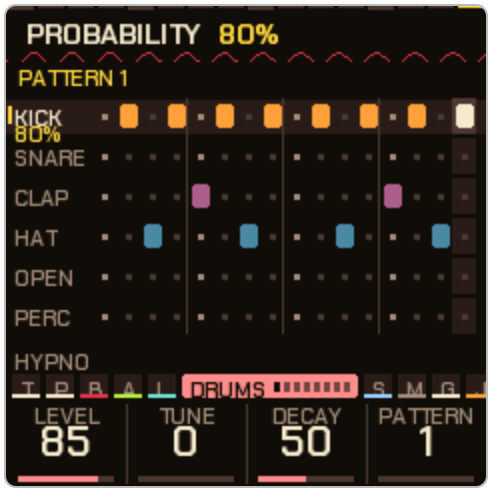
LINK	WHAT IT DOES
K>Bass	Each kick opens the bass's filter, which then closes again over the beat. The bass rolls along with your kick pattern. The amount sets how far it opens and how long it takes to close.
S>Pad	Each snare or clap flashes the pad's filter open and makes it a little louder, so the pad answers the backbeat.
H>Acid	A hat that lands on an acid note accents it. Busier hats make a squelchier 303.
P>Clock	The acid line only moves on when the perc lane hits, so the perc pattern in the sequencer becomes the acid's rhythm. In a breakdown or build, when the drums drop out, the acid runs free again.

Muting a drum with FX silences it, but its hits still drive the links. Mute the perc and it becomes a silent clock for the acid.

8 THE SEQUENCER



The sequencer



Probability set on a lane with SEL + KNOB 3

The sequencer is where you write the drum patterns. **Hold SEQ** to open it. Tap **SEQ** to go back to the Drums page.

- There are six **lanes**, one for each drum: kick, snare, clap, closed hat, open hat and perc. Each has sixteen steps and its own colour.
- The sixteen **white keys** are the steps of the drum you're on. They light where it hits, and a moving light shows where the beat is. Tap a key to turn that hit on or off.
- **OCT-** and **OCT+** choose the previous or next drum.
- The knobs set the drum's **Level**, **Tune** (+-1 octave) and **Decay**, and which **Pattern** you're editing. You can edit a pattern before it plays. A pattern change waits for the next bar.

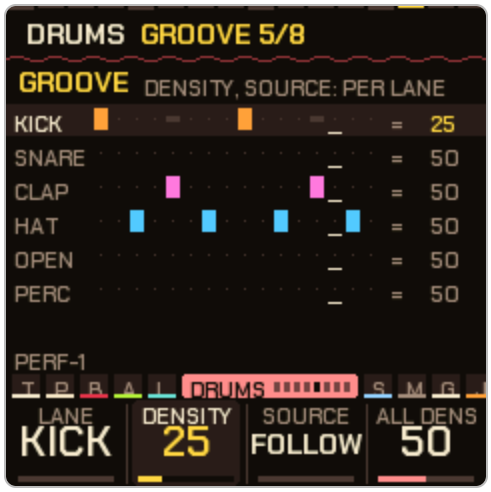
With **SEL** held:

SEL +	DOES
White keys 1-6 (F3 G3 A3 B3 C4 D4)	Choose the pattern to edit
Black keys 1-6	Copy this pattern into pattern 1-6
OCT-	Clear this drum's lane
OCT+	Put back the piece's own lane

Tricks: SEL + a knob, on the lane you're on:

SEL +	DOES
KNOB 1	Fills the lane with a **Euclidean** pattern: n hits in 16 steps, spread as evenly as possible. Many traditional rhythms are built this way. 0 clears the lane.
KNOB 2	**Rotates** that pattern, shifting it 0-15 steps later round the bar.
KNOB 3	Sets the lane's **probability**, in steps of 5 %. That's the chance each hit sounds. Below 100, the lane's name shows its chance. Rolls and fills you hold on top still sound.
KNOB 4	Sets the lane's **length**, 1-16 steps. 16 is a full bar. A shorter lane loops on its own, against the others. This is called **polymeter**. The screen shows `L5` (for 5 steps) under the lane's name, with a mark where it ends and the steps beyond dimmed. A short lane counts from the start of the song, not the bar, so a 5-step hat against the 16-step kick lines up again only every 80 steps.

Probability and length are stored with the piece. The Euclidean fill and rotation change the pattern itself, so they stay in it if you store the piece.



The Groove page

The Groove page: density and borrowing lanes. The **Groove** page (press **SEQ** five times, or turn the dial past Drum drift) makes a lane busier or sparser without editing it, or lets it play another pattern's lane. It draws every lane as it plays: a bright hit is as written, a white one is added, a dash is one taken out.

KNOB	DOES
Lane	The lane you're setting (kick … perc)
Density	50 plays the lane exactly as written. Turn it down and the least important hits drop out first (the off-sixteenths, then the off-eighths, the beats last). Turn it up and hits are added on the most important empty steps (at 100, half of them). The pattern itself is never changed.
Source	**Follow** plays the piece's own lane. Pattern 1-6 makes the lane play that pattern's lane from the next bar. For example, take the hats from pattern 4 while the kick stays on pattern 1. A lane set like this shows its pattern's number after its name.
All dens	Moves every lane's density at once

You can also set Source in the sequencer: **black keys 1-6** set it for the lane you're on, and **black key 7** sets it back to following the piece. Density and Source are stored with the piece, and scenes carry them.

Steps: ratchets, push and level



The Steps page

Each lane also has **step tricks**, a ratchet, a push and a level for each of its sixteen steps. They sit under the six patterns, so they apply whichever pattern is playing. Set them on the **Steps** page (press **SEQ** six times, or turn the dial past Groove).

1. Turn KNOB 1 to choose the lane.
2. Press a **white key** to choose the step. The key lights, and the page shows the lane as it plays.
3. Set the step with the other knobs:

KNOB	DOES
Ratchet	Repeats the hit inside its step, as a quick roll: **x2**, **x3**, **x4**, **x6**. A **flam** adds a quiet grace note just before the hit. A **swell** plays three or four hits getting louder.
Push	Makes the hit land late, 0 to 7 twelfths of a step, for a laid-back snare. At 128 BPM each twelfth is about 10 ms. It can only be late, never early.
Level	**Normal**, **ghost** (very soft), **soft** or **accent**

The page draws each step as a bar. Its height is the level, the push shifts it right, and the ratchet's hits show underneath.

The tricks are stored with the piece. Pieces stored with older firmware have none. They act on the hits the pattern plays, so a trick on an empty step waits until a hit lands there. They're skipped in fills, builds and breakdowns, on the hit the drop lands on, and in the first bar after **PLAY**.

Some genres come with tricks already set. The off-beat hats are soft in lofi, house, garage and most of the rest. The off-beat hats are accented in disco, house and electro. The backbeat is accented in DnB, breaks, funk and synthwave. The snare is laid back in lofi and trip-hop, and reggae's rim a touch. Trap has triplet rolls and a swell on its last hat beat.

Feel: ghosts, accents, comping and looseness



The Feel page

The **Feel** page (press **SEQ** seven times) holds the things that make a groove sound played by a person.

KNOB	DOES
Ghosts (0-100)	Adds the genre's **ghost notes**, very soft hits between the main ones: soft snares, plus soft kicks in lofi, breaks, funk and trip-hop. They go on steps the pattern doesn't have. At 100, about six in ten of those steps sound. Lofi, house, DnB, breaks, garage, funk and trip-hop have ghost steps. The other genres don't change.
Accents (0-100)	How much the accents and ghosts from the Steps page count. 50 plays them as marked, 0 plays every level the same, 100 exaggerates them.
Pad comp	The rhythm of the pad's stabs (comping is the rhythm a keyboard player chops chords in). It affects the stab sounds: Stabs, Dub, Pings, Hits, Rave, Wurli, Mallet, Brass and Pluck. **Auto** uses the genre's own rhythm. **Hold** never stabs, so a stab sound plays as a held pad. The other choices force stabs on any pad sound: **Off-beat**, **On-beat**, **3-3-2** (eighths grouped 3+3+2), **Charleston** (the old jazz "long-short" rhythm), **Syncopated**, **Sparse** and **Eighths**.
Humanize (0-100)	A little looseness. Each hit lands a touch softer and a touch late.

Phrase: chains, slices, half and double time, conditions



The Phrase page

The **Phrase** page (press **SEQ** eight times) shapes what the patterns do over several bars. Everything on it is stored with the piece, including the condition for each lane.

Chain plays a different pattern each bar, round and round. The choices are **12** (patterns 1, 2), **1112**, **1123**, **1134** (the chain of the Amen break, the famous drum loop), **1213**, **1234**, **1232**, **1115** and **123456**. While a chain is on, it picks the pattern at every bar line. The Pattern knob, held pattern keys and Drum drift's pattern changes give way to it, but Drum drift's fills still come. Turn it off and the patterns are yours again. Turning a chain on, or changing it, starts it from its first bar.

Slice plays the drum steps in a different order. It affects only the drums, and a lane with its own length keeps its steps.

SLICE	WHAT YOU HEAR
Halves	The two halves of the bar swapped
Stutter	The first beat of each half repeated
Reverse	The bar backwards
Delay	The second half an eighth late
Beats	The middle two beats swapped
Mirror	The second half backwards
Double	The first half twice
Swap	The beats within each half swapped
Auto	The last bar of every four gets one of the above, picked at random

Time changes the speed the pattern is read at. **Half** stretches it over two bars, with the hats in eighths (turns DnB into drumstep). **Double** plays it twice in a bar, and a hit on an odd step joins the step before.

Cond sets a **condition** for the lane chosen on the Groove page, the Steps page or the sequencer: which bars its hits play in. The knob shows the first letters of its setting.

COND	THE LANE'S HITS PLAY
Always	Every bar
1:2	Odd bars (the first, third …)
2:2	Even bars
1:4	The first bar of every four
4:4	The last bar of every four
1:8	The first bar of every eight
Fill	Only in fill bars
No fill	Everywhere except fill bars

A condition only decides whether the pattern's own hits sound. Fills still add theirs.

9 EFFECTS



The FX menu, with Gate 1/8 and Low-pass latched

The effects are for changing the music live while it plays. Press **FX** to open the effects menu, and press it again to close it. While the menu is open, every key is an effect.

The keys hold four banks of effects: **FX**, **BEAT FX**, **FLEX BEAT** and **DJ SNIPS**. Turn the **SELECT** dial to move between them. It stops at the first and last bank. The knobs become the **FX knobs** (below).

Tap or hold

- **Tap** a key (let go within a quarter of a second) and its effect stays on. This is called latching. Tap it again to turn it off.
- **Hold** a key and the effect plays only while you hold it.

You can latch several effects at once. On the screen, a held key shows as a lit tile, and a latched one has a bar beside it.

Each kind of effect has its own colour, so you can find keys at a glance:

COLOUR	EFFECTS
Cyan	Repeats
Green	Filters
Yellow	Gates and the pump
Red	The drum mutes
Pink	Colour effects (phaser, flanger and the like)
Violet	Builds
Orange	Moves that bend the playback: reverse, stops, scatter
Teal	Flex Beat

Latched effects keep playing after you close the menu. The **FX** button blinks and `FX` shows next to the tempo, to remind you. The keys go back to playing the scale or a voice. To turn an effect off, open FX again and tap its key.

To turn everything off at once, press **OCT-** in the FX menu. This clears all effects, puts the FX knobs back to their home positions, and clears all mutes and solos. If you didn't mean it, **GLO** + `B3` undoes it. Tapping **SAVE** in the FX menu still starts a breakdown (section 10).

The FX knobs

These four knobs work in the FX menu, on the Perform screen and on the visualizers, so you don't need the menu open to use them.

KNOB	WHAT IT DOES
Filter	Turn left of centre for a low-pass filter, which cuts the highs and makes the sound darker. It closes from 16 kHz down to about 250 Hz. Turn right of centre for a high-pass filter, which cuts the lows and thins the sound out. It rises from 20 Hz to about 1.6 kHz. In the middle it's off. The screen shows `OFF` in the middle and readings like `LP 40` or `HP 40` as you turn.
Crush	Makes the sound grittier and more lo-fi, like an old sampler. Turned all the way up, it's about 5.5 kHz and 5 bits.
Throw	Sends the mix into the echo. Turn it up for more echo that repeats for longer.
Wash	Sends the mix into the reverb.

The FX knobs aren't saved. They go back to home when you power off. A scene does store them (section 10). While any FX knob is away from home, the header says `KNOB`.

Bank 1: FX

The 27 keys run from `F3` to `G5`. On the screen they're laid out in three columns of nine.

KEY	EFFECT	WHAT IT DOES
F3	Sweep	A filter sweeps up and down in time with the tempo.
F#3	Gate 16	A trance gate: chops the synths on and off in sixteenth notes.
G3	Ring mod	Gives the sound a metallic, bell-like clang.
G#3	Gate 8	The same gate, in eighth notes.
A3	Freeze	Grabs the sound and holds it as a steady drone, built from tiny repeated grains of it.
A#3	Gate pattern	The gate playing its own rhythm, which you set on the Gate page.
B3	Reverse swell	The last beat or so plays backwards once, getting louder as it goes.
C4	Talk	Makes the whole mix "talk" by sweeping it through the vowels A E I O U.
C#4	Phaser	A swirling, sweeping sound.
D4	Wah	An auto-wah: a filter that opens up as the music gets louder.
D#4	Flanger	A jet-plane whoosh.
E4	Reverse	Plays the music backwards.
F4	Tape stop	The music slows down and stops, like a tape machine switched off.
F#4	Tape	Makes it sound like worn tape: wobbling pitch (wow and flutter) and drive.
G4	FILTER	A filter on the tracks you choose: low, high, band, notch or peak (see below).
G#4	Roll	Repeats that speed up.
A4	DELAY	Sends the tracks you choose into the echo, with long repeats (see below).
A#4	Pump	Ducks the sound in a rhythm so it "pumps", the way music does when a kick is pushing it down. This is called sidechain ducking.
B4	PHASE	A phaser on the tracks you choose (see below).
C5	M:DRUMS	Mutes all four drums while held: the classic drop-the-drums move.
C#5	Riser	A build-up: a filter and the reverb climbing.
D5	Throw	Throws the mix into the echo.

KEY	EFFECT	WHAT IT DOES
D#5	Vinyl	Adds record crackle, hiss and pops underneath.
E5	Fill	Plays a drum fill.
F5	Low-pass	A low-pass filter that closes in, making the sound darker.
F#5	FILL>	Tap it and the drums play a fill in the next bar.
G5	High-pass	A high-pass filter that thins the sound out from the bottom.

M:DRUMS works only while you hold it, like any held key. The single drums' mutes (kick, hats, snare, perc) are on the same keys of the BEAT FX bank. To mute the other tracks, or to solo anything, use the mix map on the **GLO** layer (section 10).

Punch-ins on tracks: FILTER, DELAY and PHASE. The other effects work on the whole mix. These three work only on the tracks you pick, the way Caustic puts effects on one machine: hold DELAY and only the acid and the pluck echo away, hold FILTER and only the synths go thin while the drums stay punchy. Hold **SEL** and press the key to open its settings page; its last knob is **Targets**:

TARGETS	WHAT IT HITS
ALL	Everything
DRUMS	All four drums together
SYNTHS	Pad, bass, acid and pluck (everything but the drums)
PAD, BASS, ACID, PLUCK	That one track
ACID+PLK, PAD+PLK, BASS+ACID	Those two

KEY	SETTINGS
FILTER	Type (low, high, band, notch, peak), Cutoff, Reso, Targets
DELAY	Send (how much goes into the echo), Repeats (how long it echoes on; it uses the piece's echo time), Targets
PHASE	Rate, Depth, Mix (100 is the deepest swirl), Targets

Hold two of them at once and they share their tracks: both act on everything either one is aimed at. The effect is on a track's own sound; its reverb and echo sends carry

on as before, so a filtered pad still has its unfiltered reverb tail. The whole-mix versions are still here: Phaser on C#4, Throw on D5, the filters on F5 and G5.

Bank 2: BEAT FX



The BEAT FX bank

These effects chop and rework the beat.

KEYS	EFFECT	WHAT IT DOES
F3 to C4	Beat repeats	Loops a short slice of what just played, over and over. From slow to fast: 1/2, 1/4, 1/6 (a quarter-note triplet), 1/8, 1/16, 1/32, then 1/8T and 1/16T (triplets, three in the space of two). If you hold more than one, the shortest wins. A repeat starts on the next sixteenth note.
D4	Scatter	Shuffles the last few slices into a new order.
D#4	Brake	Slows the music to a halt, like a record when you stop the turntable.
E4	Spin back	Spins the music backwards, like a DJ pulling a record back.
F4	Half time	Makes the music play at half speed.
F#4	Scratch	An automatic record scratch.
G4, A4, B4, C5	Drum mutes	Kick, hats, snare, perc, each muted while held (bank 1 has M:DRUMS, all four, on C5).
G#4	Reverse	Plays the music backwards.
A#4	Tape stop	Slows the music to a stop.
C#5	Hat roll	The hi-hats play every step, in 32nd notes.
D5	Hat trip	The hi-hats roll in triplets.
D#5	Snare roll	A snare roll that gets louder through the bar.
E5	Flam	A quick extra hit just before every snare and clap.
F5	Double kick	Each kick plays again half a step later.

Beat repeat and reverse play back the last moment of the mix, just under a second of it. At slow tempos a 1/2 repeat doesn't fit in that, so it plays as a 1/4.

Bank 3: FLEX BEAT



The FLEX BEAT bank

Flex Beat chops up the last moment of the music and replays it as a new one-bar pattern, locked to the beat. There are 27 patterns, one on every key from `F3` to `G5`:

PATTERN	WHAT IT DOES
Bt Rept	Loops the last beat.
Hf Rept	Loops the last half bar.
Bt Rev	Plays the last beat backwards.
Skip	Loops the last beat with every other sixteenth left out.
Trance	A 3-3-2 gate: the music cuts on and off in a three, three, two rhythm.
Gate 8	Cuts the music on and off in eighth notes.
Double	Plays each sixteenth of the last beat twice.
Shuffle	Loops the last beat with its sixteenths in a new order.
Bck-Fwd	The last beat forwards, then backwards.
Roll out	Plays normally for three beats, then a stutter on the last beat.
Build	Plays normally, then a stutter that speeds up.
Scratch	Rocks the last two sixteenths back and forth, like a scratch.
Dropout	Mostly silence, with the music coming through on a few steps.
Jump bk	Jumps back to repeat the last beat, then carries on.
Halves	Swaps the two halves of the last half bar.
Swap	Swaps the sixteenth notes in pairs.
Mirror	Forwards, then backwards.
Lag	Plays late, leaving a gap.
Slowmo	Plays every sixteenth twice: half time without the pitch dropping.
Skip 3	A pattern in threes over the bar of four.
Stut up	A stutter that speeds up.
Stut dn	A stutter that slows down.
Tresillo	The 3-3-2 rhythm (called tresillo) on the last sixteenth.

PATTERN	WHAT IT DOES
Offbeat	Plays only the off-beats.
Cut 4	Leaves a gap every fourth step.
Rev 8	Plays the half bar backwards, twice.
Half gap	Plays the half bar once, then silence.

For plain stutters, use the beat repeats on bank 2.

Tap a key to latch it, or hold it to play it. A pad you hold down keeps repeating its bar. When you let go, the bar that's playing finishes, so it always ends on the bar line.

Flex Beat works on the last 8 sixteenth notes you heard (fewer at slow tempos), and it keeps working on that same stretch for as long as it plays.

The Flex settings page (below) has three settings:

- **Quant** sets when a pattern starts: at once (off), on the next beat, or on the next bar. Bar is the default.
- **Mode** is one shot or loop. In one shot, the bar plays to its end and then a latched pad turns itself off. In loop, it keeps going until you let go of the pad or tap it off.
- **Mix** goes from dry (just the music) to wet (just the Flex pattern).

Bank 4: DJ SNIPS



The DJ SNIPS bank

These are the sound effects a DJ throws in over a set, made on the spot. The 27 keys, `F3` to `G5`, are:

AIR HORN (held), AIR BLAST (a short blast), HORN MIN (a minor chord, held), RAVE HORN (the "hoover" rave sound, held), SIREN, SIREN 2, SIREN 3, LASER, LASER LO, ZAP, ZAP HI, BEEP, BEEP LO, BEEP HI, 2 BEEP, WHOOP, WHOOP 2, DUB SIREN, DUB LOW, DROP, DROP LONG, RISER, REWIND, CRASH, RAVE STAB (the hoover as a short stab), BELL and SNR ROLL (a snare roll that speeds up).

Up to four can sound at once. Snips play when you press the key. They don't latch.

The Snips settings page has four settings:

- **Pitch**: normal, an octave up, or an octave down.
- **Play**: HELD or ONE SHOT. In HELD, the long sounds (the horns, sirens, dub siren, riser and snare roll) last as long as you hold the key, and the others play to their end. In ONE SHOT, every snip plays to its end, and the long ones last a second or so.
- **Echo**: dry, some or lots. How much of the snips goes to the echo and the reverb.
- **Level**: how loud the snips are.

While the Snips page is up, the keys play the snips, so you can try them out.

Settings pages



A settings page: the Gate

Every effect that has settings has its own page, with a picture of what the effect is doing. You can get to a page in four ways:

- In the FX menu, hold **SEL** and press a key. You get the page for that key's effect. If the effect has no settings, the screen says so.
- Press **FX** twice quickly for the page of the effect you used last.
- Press **SEL** + **FX** to step through all the effects' pages, then back to the keys. Talk and Wah come right after the phaser and the flanger. (The unit's own settings, such as Auto DJ, SET and MIDI IN, are a separate walk: hold **HOME**, section 13.)

- Once you're on a settings page, turn the **SELECT** dial to move to the next or previous one. It stops at the ends.

Press **FX** to close the page.

The effect is switched on while its page is showing, so you hear what you change. The roll, riser, scatter, brake, half time, scratch, freeze and reverse swell only sound while you hold a key. The dots at the right of the knob strip show where you are in the list of pages.

The four knobs, **KNOB1** to **KNOB4**, set the four settings on each page:

PAGE	KNOB1	KNOB2	KNOB3	KNOB4
Gate (chops the sound on and off in a rhythm)	Pattern: 3-3-3, tres, offbeat, Euclid 5, 7 or 9, waltz, chop, sparse, dense, dotted, 5/10, custom	Length: 2-16 steps	Targets: no drums, pad, bass, acid, drums, hats, kick, all, no kick, kick+bass, pluck	Depth
Phaser (a swirling sweep)	Rate	Depth	Feedback	Mix
Flanger (a jet-plane whoosh)	Rate	Depth	Feedback	Mix
Vinyl (record crackle and hiss)	Level	Crackle	Hiss	Tone
Tape (wobbly, driven tape sound)	Wow	Flutter	Drive	Dull
Roll (repeats that speed up)	From: 1/2 to 1/64	To	Each: 1/2, 1, 2 or 4 beats at a rate	Swell
Pump (rhythmic ducking)	Depth	Release	Every: 1/2, 1/4, 1/8, 1/16, or KICK (on every kick, wherever the kicks fall)	Targets
Riser (a build-up)	Time: about 1-12 s	Filter	Wash	Echo
Scatter (shuffled slices)	Chaos	Reverse	Slice: 1/32, 1/16, 1/8	Slices: 2-8
Brake (a record slowing to a stop)	Time	Spin back	Return	Dull
Half time (half-speed playback)	Speed: x1.5, x2, x4	Slide	-	-
Sweep (a filter moving in time)	Every: 8, 4, 2, 1 bar, 1/2, 1/4, 1/8	Depth	Reso	Type: low, high, band
Scratch (a record scratch)	Every: 1/4, 1/8, 1/16, 1/32	Reach: 1/16, 1/8, 1/4, 1/2	Style: baby, pull	-
Freeze (holds the sound as a drone)	Size	Spread	Grains: 1-4	-

PAGE	KNOB1	KNOB2	KNOB3	KNOB4
Rv swell (backwards, getting louder)	Length: 1/2, 1, 2 beats	Mix	-	-
Ring mod (a metallic clang)	Tone: 40-800 Hz	Mix	-	-
Auto DJ (runs the sections for you; section 10)	Scenes: at once, next bar	Groove: 8, 16, 32, 64 bars, sync	Break: short, half, full	Fill: off, on
Auto FX (effects played by themselves; section 10)	Auto FX: off, gentle, medium, wild	Every: 4, 8, 16, 32 bars	Length: a beat, half bar, a bar, 2 bars	Pick: genre, any
SET (shapes a longer DJ set; section 10)	Rounds: 1, 2, 4, 8	Ramp: off, +2, +4, +8, +12 BPM	Intro: off, 1, 2, 4, 8 min	Mix: cut, 4, 8, 16, 32 bars
Settings	Key: same, +2, +3, +5, +7	Voices: DX, DY	-	-
USB & MIDI	Level: knob, fixed	MIDI out: off, on	MIDI map: GM, M:Samples, MPC Sample, SP-404	-
MIDI IN	Notes: scale, pads, M:S, MPK	Channel: all, 1-16	USB host: off, on (never kept)	Knob CCs: off, in, out, in+out
FILTERS	Pad: low, high, band, notch, peak	Bass: the same	Acid: the same	-
SCREAM	Drive: 0-100	Scream: 0-100	Wow: 0-100	Target: acid, bass, both
SCREEN	Zoom: off, on	Saver: off, 1, 3, 10 min	Lights: off, show	Scanlines: off, on
SAMPLE (section 13)	Sounds: all, drums, synths, by key	FX: off, on	Gap: 0.5, 1, 2, 4 s	-

PAGE	KNOB1	KNOB2	KNOB3	KNOB4
FILTER (G4)	Type: low … peak	Cutoff	Reso	Targets: all, drums, synths, one track, two
DELAY (A4)	Send	Repeats	Targets	-
PHASE (B4)	Rate	Depth	Mix	Targets
Repeat (the beat repeats on bank 2)	Pitch: -12 to +12 semitones	Decay: 0 to 6 dB a repeat	Gate: full, 3/4, half, 1/4	Refresh: off, beat, bar
Flex (Flex Beat)	Quant: off, beat, bar	Mode: one shot, loop	Mix	-
Snips (DJ snips)	Pitch	Play	Echo	Level
Talk (vowel sounds)	Every: 2 bars, 1 bar, 1/2, 1/4, 1/8	Depth	Reso	Mix
Wah (auto-wah)	Sens	Range	Reso	Mix

What some of these mean:

- **Mix** is the balance between the plain sound and the effect. **Reso** (resonance) makes the filter ring and whistle at its setting. **Feedback** feeds the effect back into itself for a stronger result. **Targets** chooses which parts of the music the effect works on.
- **Gate patterns.** Euclid 5, 7 or 9 spreads 5, 7 or 9 hits as evenly as possible over the steps. Custom is a pattern you edit yourself (below).
- **Roll.** From and To set the speed the repeats start and end at. Each sets how often a roll happens.
- **Riser.** Time is how long it takes to climb. Filter, Wash and Echo set how much of each it builds up.
- **Settings page.** Key is the drop's key change (section 13). Voices chooses which set of thirty built-in DX7 voices the pluck's `DX` sounds use (section 7).
- **SCREEN page.** Zoom shows a knob's name and value large as you turn it. Saver is the screensaver. Lights makes the key lights follow the music. Scanlines darkens every other row of the screen by a quarter, like an old CRT TV.

- **USB & MIDI page.** Level chooses whether the USB audio follows the **MASTER** knob or stays at a fixed level, so a recording doesn't change when you turn the volume. MIDI out sends notes out over USB. MIDI map chooses where the notes go (section 14).
- **Repeat page.** Pitch makes each repeat step toward that pitch over four beats while you hold the key, which sounds like a build. Every repeat still starts on the beat grid. Decay makes each repeat quieter than the last, for a dub-style tail. Gate sets how much of each slice sounds: all of it, 3/4, half or 1/4. Refresh grabs a fresh slice of the newest music every beat or bar, which DJs call a slip roll. It only works where there's enough recent music held to do it.

The Gate page. The white keys show the pattern's steps. They're lit where the gate opens, and the step that's playing is marked. Press a key to edit a step, and the pattern becomes "custom". A pattern of 12 or 10 steps against the bar of 16 drifts against the beat and comes back around, which is called a polymeter. **Gate 16** and **Gate 8** share this page.

All of these settings, and the gate's pattern and targets, are kept when you power off (section 13).

10 PERFORMING



A build

These are the moves for playing a set live. Most of them wait for the next bar, so everything stays in time.

- **Breakdown: tap SAVE.** In the bar before the breakdown, the percussion, the open hi-hat and half the hats drop out, to let the energy go. Then the drums stop on the next bar. In house, techno, dubstep and dub the kick keeps going, and in drum and bass the hats keep going. The mix gets darker, the bass filter closes and the pad gets louder. The breakdown lasts as long as you leave it.
- **Build: tap SAVE again.** A snare roll climbs in pitch while the bass opens up. It lasts four bars (two in trap, lofi and trip-hop, eight in house). In the last bar the open hat plays every eighth note, and in the four-on-the-floor genres the kick comes back. Then comes the drop.
- **Drop: hold SAVE.** Everything comes straight back in on the next bar. **SAVE** lights up during a breakdown or build, and blinks while it waits for the bar.
- **Freeze: REC.** The chord holds and the reverb rings on. Press **REC** again to let the music move on.
- **Next chord: EDIT.** Moves to the next chord at the next bar. With your own progression playing, it moves to the next slot.
- **The scale: the keys.** Each key adds its note to the scale or takes it away. The root note always stays. **ALGORITHM** picks a mode (a ready-made scale).
- **Patterns.** Change the drum pattern with **KNOB4** on the Drums page, or with **SEL** + white keys 1-6. A change waits for the next bar, so if you turn the knob past several patterns, only the one you stop on plays.

Drum drift makes the drums change by themselves as you play. Press **SEQ** four times to get to it. It's off by default. It has four settings:

- **Change** moves to the next pattern, or to a random one from pattern 1 up to the **Pool** number.
- **Every** sets how often: every so many bars, or with each chord change. The bar before each change ends in a fill, with the snare and hats rolling in.
- **Mutate** rewrites the pattern a little at the same moments. **Shift** moves a hit or two by a step. **Morph** also adds or removes a hit.

The kick and clap always stay as written, and a snare on a beat never moves, so the groove keeps its footing. What Mutate changes stays in the pattern, so store the piece to keep it. Mutate also works with Change off, slowly wearing one pattern into something new. Your Drum drift settings stay the same when you change piece or genre.



Drum drift

PERF-1 doesn't save songs. To keep a performance, record the audio (or the MIDI out) into your computer's recording software, and keep the takes you like.

The Perform screen

Press **HOME** on the Tempo page to get here. From any other page, press **HOME** twice. The screen shows:

- the section you're in (GROOVE, BREAK, BUILD) and how far the auto-DJ is through it
- the sixteen steps of the bar
- the eight tracks (kick, hats, snare, perc, bass, acid, pad, pluck) with their levels. A muted track has a line through it, and a soloed one is filled in.
- the four scenes
- which effects are on
- the **mood**

On this screen the keys are the track mix (the mix map, below), the knobs are the FX knobs, and **ALGORITHM** sets the mood.

The mix map (GLO held)

The mix map lets you mute, solo and recall scenes while you play. Hold **GLO** and the screen shows what each key does. On the Perform screen or a visualizer you don't need to hold **GLO**: just press the keys, with FX closed. The load meter is at the top right.

A mute stays on until you press the key again. The black key above a track solos it, so you hear only that track.

KEY	DOES
F3 / F#3	Mute / solo the kick
G3 / G#3	Mute / solo the hats
A3 / A#3	Mute / solo the snare (with the clap)
B3	Undo (press again to redo)
C4 / C#4	Mute / solo the perc
D4 / D#4	Mute / solo the bass
E4	Tap tempo
F4 / F#4	Mute / solo the acid
G4 / G#4	Mute / solo the pad
A4 / A#4	Mute / solo all four drums
B4	Mute the pluck
C5, C#5, D5, D#5	Scenes 1-4
E5	Reset all
F5	Auto-DJ on / off
F#5	Solo the pluck
G5	DJ new pieces on / off

Scenes are snapshots of your performance that you can jump back to. A scene stores which effects are latched, the mutes and solos, where the FX knobs are, and the groove: each drum lane's density and source pattern, and the pattern that's playing (which comes back from the next bar).

- **Tap** a scene key to recall it. While the music plays, it comes in on the next bar if the Scenes setting on the Auto DJ page is `NEXT BAR` (the default). Otherwise it comes in at once. The FX knobs glide to their stored positions over about a second.
- **Hold** a scene key for 0.6 seconds to store things as they are right now.

Scenes are kept until you power off.

Undo (`B3`) puts things back as they were before the last big change: a scene, a reset, muting all drums, or a clear. Press it again to redo.

Reset all (`E5`) turns off every latched effect, clears all mutes and solos, and puts the FX knobs back home. You can undo it.

Tap tempo (`E4`): tap it four times or so in time with the beat you want. The tempo becomes the average of your taps.



The mix map

The auto-DJ

The auto-DJ plays the breakdowns, builds and drops for you, so you can focus on the effects and the mix. Press **GLO** + `F5` to start it. `DJ` shows in the header, and the Perform screen counts the bars through each part. It runs through these sections, always on the bar:

1. A **groove** of 8, 16, 32 or 64 bars (16 by default).
2. A **drum fill** in the last bar of the groove, if Fill is on.
3. A **breakdown**: short (4 bars), half the length of the groove (at least 4 bars, the default), or full (as long as the groove).

4. A **build** (its length depends on the genre). The riser climbs, and the music cuts out for the last two sixteenth notes. Then the **drop**: everything comes back at once on the first beat, with the kick, a clap and an open hat that rings like a crash, usually on the home chord of the key.
5. The groove again.

You set Groove, Break, Fill and Scenes on the **Auto DJ** settings page. Groove has a fifth setting, **Sync**. With Sync, the groove lasts until the chord changes. (How long a chord lasts is set by **Drift** on the Tempo page.) The bar before a chord change is a fill, and the bar of the change is the breakdown.

Turn on **DJ new pieces** (**GLO** + `G5`) and the auto-DJ brings in the next piece in the bank on the fill's bar, so the breakdown and the drop belong to the new piece. If you press **SAVE** yourself, the auto-DJ simply carries on from there. If the drop's key change is on (section 13), it happens on each drop.



The SET page

Auto FX

Auto FX plays effects by itself, like a DJ who throws in a filter sweep or a tape stop before the next phrase. Turn it on from the **Auto FX** settings page (hold **HOME**, then turn **SELECT**: it comes right after Auto DJ). It works with or without the auto-DJ.

- **Each effect ends on a phrase line.** With **Every** at 8 bars, an effect leads into bar 9, 17, 25 and so on, finishing exactly as the next phrase starts. **Length** is the longest one may take: a beat, half a bar, a bar or two bars. Short effects such as a throw or a tape stop always stay short.
- **It picks what suits the moment.** In a groove: gates, repeats, sweeps and filters. In a breakdown: washes such as the reverse swell, freeze and tape. In a build: rolls and rising filters. At the end of a build (Medium and Wild), a stop, reverse, brake or spin-back leads into the drop, and the four bars after a drop are left alone.

- **It knows the genre.** With **Pick** on Genre, each genre's own effects come four times as often: throws and tape in dub and reggae, the pump and filters in house and disco, scratches and repeats in breaks and funk, hat rolls and half time in trap and dubstep, gates and flangers in psy. **Any** treats them all alike.
- **Auto FX** sets how much: **Gentle** keeps to washes and sweeps; **Medium** adds gates, filters, repeats and rolls; **Wild** adds stops, brakes, scatter and half time. It never plays the same effect twice in a row. A phrase line is sometimes skipped (more often at Gentle).
- **It gets out of your way.** Nothing plays while you hold or latch an effect yourself, and playing one ends an automatic one at once. It also waits while the FX menu is open, during the intro, and when the music is stopped.

The name of each effect shows in the header as it plays. The settings are kept across power-off.

The **SET** settings page shapes a longer set. Hold **HOME** for the settings; it comes after Auto FX on the dial.

- **Rounds** gives each piece 1, 2, 4 or 8 rounds before DJ new pieces moves on. A round is one groove, breakdown, build and drop. The header and the Perform screen count them, like `R2/4`.
- **Ramp** makes the tempo climb over a piece's rounds of groove, by +2, +4, +8 or +12 BPM, one BPM at a time. If you change the tempo by hand, the climb carries on from there. The next piece starts at its own tempo.
- **Intro** builds the music up slowly from nothing. When you press Play, the tracks come in one at a time over 1, 2, 4 or 8 minutes. The pad starts in the first bar, then come the hats, the perc, the kick, the snare, the bass, the pluck and last the acid, each a seventh of the way further through. This is handy for mixing in from another deck, or for scratching or sampling over just a pad and a hat. The header counts down, like `INTRO 1:42`, and the auto-DJ stays in its groove until every track is in. Stop and Play again to restart the intro.
- **Mix** changes pieces the way a DJ changes records. A piece that comes in on the bar (the auto-DJ's next piece, the set list's next slot, or **SEL** + **PRESETS**) starts at the tempo that was playing, then glides to its own tempo over 4, 8, 16 or 32 bars. **Cut** jumps straight to the new tempo, as before. With a set list that goes from a slow piece to a fast one, a long Mix carries the whole set up (or down) smoothly. Turning the tempo by hand stops the glide where it is.

The set list



The Set list page

A set list is the pieces you want to play, in your order, from any genres. Press **GLO** twice (Global, then **Set list**) to open it.

KNOB	SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
KNOB1	Slot	Which of the 16 slots you're editing. The first 16 white keys choose a slot too.
KNOB2	Genre	The slot's genre. Turn it on an empty slot and the piece playing goes in. Turn it right down to *Empty* to clear the slot.
KNOB3	Piece	The slot's piece, 01 to 10.
KNOB4	Play	*On*: the set list takes over from the bank (below).

With **Play** on:

- **PRESETS** steps to the next or last slot in the list, across genres, instead of the next piece in the bank. With **SEL** held while the music plays, the slot waits for the next bar. The header says `SET 2/5` and the piece's title.
- The **auto-DJ** brings in the next slot instead of the bank's next piece (you don't need DJ new pieces on). It changes on the fill's bar, after the piece's **Rounds**, so the breakdown and the drop belong to the new piece.
- Empty slots are skipped, and after the last slot it goes back to the first.

The list on screen shows each slot's genre and piece. The slot playing is bright, and the slot you're editing has a bar behind it. The white keys light the slots in use, and the slot playing blinks.

The set list is kept with the theme, Tune and MIDI out. It plays your stored pieces as they are stored, and factory pieces as they come.

Mood

Mood is one control that makes the whole piece calmer or more intense. On the Perform screen and the visualizers, **ALGORITHM** sets it. 0 is chill, 100 is peak, and 50 (the middle, and the default) leaves the piece as it is.

The further you turn from 50, the more it changes these:

- the acid's density and filter cutoff (how bright it is)
- the levels of the hats and the perc
- the pad's brightness
- the pluck's density, level and decay (shorter toward peak)
- the bass's cutoff and drive
- the reverb and echo (less toward peak)
- Evolve
- the drums' level

Mood changes what you hear, but it doesn't change the stored piece. It stays where you left it when you change piece. It isn't remembered when you power off.

The keys' lights

On most pages the keys light the scale. While the music plays, the notes of the chord playing are lit bright and the rest of the scale dim, so you can see which keys fit right now. Stopped, the whole scale is lit.

Jam



The Jam page

The **Jam** page turns the 27 keys into an instrument so you can play along with the music. Turn the **SELECT** dial to it; it comes after Global. On this page the keys never change the scale.

KNOB	SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
KNOB1	Voice	Which sound you play: the pluck, the pad, the acid or the bass. While the page is up, that part stops playing its own line. It gets it back when you leave.
KNOB2	Keys	*Scale*: every key plays a note of the scale. A black key plays the scale note at or below it, so there are no wrong notes. *Chords*: every key plays a three-note chord (a triad) from the scale. *Harp*: the keys play the scale's notes in order, one per key, from C3.
KNOB3	Octave	-2 to +2.
KNOB4	Answer	When it's on and you stop playing (after at least two notes and a short pause), the pluck plays your phrase back an octave higher at the next bar line. It does this once, then waits for your next phrase.

The page shows a keyboard with the scale's notes lit and the keys you hold bright (orange). While the music plays, the notes of the chord playing are blue, and its name is in the top right, like `Am7`. If the pluck's level is turned almost all the way down, playing it raises it to 40 so you can hear it.

Accents (SEL). The FM-1's keys can't feel how hard you press, so hold **SEL** while you play a key for an accent: a louder note, and on the acid a full accent (brighter, punchier). On the Jam page SEL + a key always plays; it doesn't change the pattern as it does elsewhere.

Capture (SEL + REC). The quickest way to write a riff is to play it. Capture takes the bar you last played on the Jam page and makes it that voice's own line:

- With the voice on **acid**, the bar goes into the Acid steps page as a 16-step line, set to **Frozen**. Each sixteenth where you played a key gets that note. The notes are stored relative to the chord at the time, so the line follows the chords from then on. A key played on a beat becomes an accent (a louder note), and a key held past the next step becomes a slide (the pitch glides into the next note). The line plays when you leave the Jam page.
- With the voice on the **pluck**, the bar goes into the Deja vu loop, set to Loop 16, Rate 1/16 and Pluck vu 100, starting at the next bar line. Turn Pluck vu down to let it drift again.
- The pad and the bass can't be captured.

Capture remembers your last 32 key presses, so play the bar first, then press **SEL** + **REC**. The header says `CAPTURED`.

11 MIXING: THE MIXER, SPACE AND THE MASTER BUS



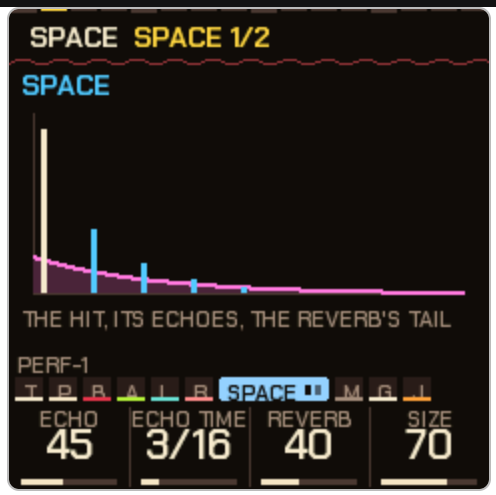
The Mixer page

The **Mixer** page sets the balance between the parts. Turn the **SELECT** dial to it; it sits between Comp/Limit and Global. It works on one layer at a time.

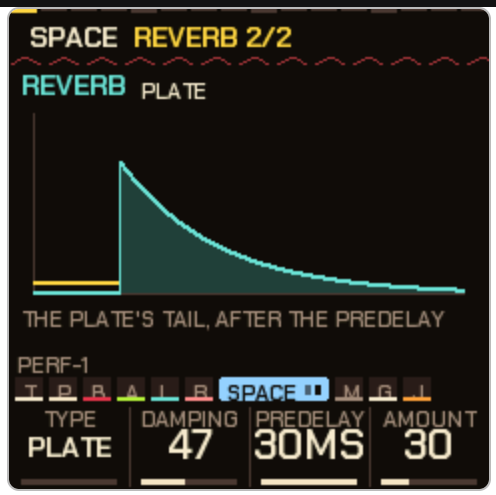
KNOB	DOES
KNOB1	Chooses the layer: pad, bass, acid, pluck or drums.
KNOB2	The layer's level. It's the same level as on the layer's own page.
KNOB3	The layer's **pan**, its place from left to right: L100 to R100. It works like a balance knob, and the middle leaves the sound as it was.
KNOB4	The layer's **send**: how much of it goes to the echo and the reverb. 50 is as it was, 0 is none, 100 is twice as much.

The page draws a strip for each layer. Each strip shows the level you've set (the fader, with its number) and the level you're actually hearing (the meter beside it). A muted track shows an `M`, and a soloed one has its name in the highlight colour. The last strip is the output's peak level. The layer you've chosen has a frame round it, with a tick under it for its pan. Everything on this page is stored with the piece.

Space and **Reverb** are the pages for the echo and the reverb. The echo is in time with the tempo: 1/8, 3/16, 1/4, dotted 1/4, 1/2 or 1 bar. **Echo** sets how much it repeats, **Reverb** how much goes into the reverb, and **Size** how long the reverb tail is.



The Space page



The Reverb page

The **Reverb** page chooses the type of reverb:

TYPE	WHAT IT IS
Plate	A classic, smooth reverb. Amount does nothing.
Shimmer	The tail is shifted an octave up and fed back into the reverb, so it sparkles. Amount sets how much is fed back.
Gated	The tail opens with the sound, stays open for a set time and then cuts off sharply (in about 10 ms). Amount sets that time, from 80 to 400 ms.

Damping (0-100, 47 by default) makes the reverb lose its highs, so higher settings sound darker. **Predelay** (6-30 ms, 30 by default) is a short gap before the reverb starts, which keeps the sound clear.

Each genre sets its own damping and predelay. Lofi and dubstep are darker, and house is brighter and shorter. Drum and bass and trap use the shimmer, and breaks and electro use the gated reverb. The page draws the tail for the type you've chosen.

The master bus



The Comp/Limit page

The master bus is the last stage before the sound leaves the FM-1. It evens out the volume and stops it from clipping. After the effects, and before the **MASTER** volume, the mix goes through two stages:

- a **compressor**, which turns the loud parts down so the mix sounds tighter and more even. It works on both sides of the stereo together.
- a **limiter**, a hard ceiling the sound can't go over. It looks a moment ahead (it delays the sound by about 1.4 ms, too little to hear), so it's ready before a peak arrives, and lets go over about 60 ms.

After the **MASTER** volume there's also a gentle soft clip as a last safety net.

KNOB	RANGE	DOES
Ratio	Off, 1.5:1, 2:1, 3:1, 4:1, 6:1, 10:1	How hard the compressor squeezes. Higher is stronger. It eases in gently (a 6 dB soft knee).
Thresh	-30 to 0 dB	The threshold: how loud the sound has to get before the compressor starts working.
Make-up	0 to +12 dB	Turns the sound back up after compressing.
Ceiling	-12 to 0 dB	The limiter's ceiling, before the **MASTER** volume.

The compressor reacts in 4 ms. It lets go in about 60 ms, more slowly (up to 400 ms) when it's turning the sound down by 9 dB or more.

The page draws the compressor's curve, with the sound going in along the bottom and coming out up the side. The dotted line is where in and out are equal, the upright tick is the threshold, and the flat tick is the ceiling. There are also live meters: **COMP**

(how much the compressor is turning down), **LIMIT** (how much the limiter is) and **OUT** (the output's peak).

The four settings are stored with the piece. The default is a light 1.5:1 at -12 dB, with +1.2 dB of make-up. Each genre brings its own: lofi and garage use 2:1, house, drum and bass and electro 3:1, and breaks, dubstep and trap 4:1 with more make-up. The limiter's ceiling is 0 dB in every genre, so it only catches sounds that would clip.

12 SHIFT



What shift does on this page

SEL is the shift button. Hold it and the keys, buttons and knobs do something else:

HOLD SEL AND PRESS	WHAT HAPPENS
White keys 1-6 (F3 G3 A3 B3 C4 D4)	Switches to pattern 1-6 on the next bar. The key of the pattern you chose lights up, and the one still playing blinks until the change. Tap the key and the new pattern stays. Hold it for more than a quarter of a second and that pattern plays only while you hold the key. Let go and the previous pattern comes back from the next bar. This is a good way to use pattern 5 or 6 as a held variation.
PRESETS	Next or previous piece, on the next bar. The screen shows `PIECE 03 NEXT BAR` until it changes.
ALGORITHM	Steps through the sounds of the voice on screen (pad, bass, acid, pluck). On the drum pages it steps through whole kits.
SEQ	Turns the links (drum hits patched into the voices, section 7) on and off.
ENV	On a pad, bass or acid page: takes that voice away from the automatic part so it only plays what you play by hand. Press again to hand it back.
FX	Walks through the effects' settings pages one by one, then back to the keys.
A key in the FX menu	Opens that effect's settings page.
HOME	Changes the middle of the sigil on the home screen: the eye or the imp.
GLO	Remote: the FM-1's panel plays the emulator (section 17). Works only when stopped, because it stops the music. If the music is playing, the screen says `STOP FIRST`.
EDIT	A secret. Works only when stopped. It starts the music by itself.
Black keys 1-6 (in the sequencer)	Copies the pattern you're editing into pattern 1-6. Without SEL, the black keys in the sequencer choose the lane's source (section 8).
OCT- (in the sequencer)	Clears this drum's lane.
OCT+ (in the sequencer)	Puts this drum's lane back to the piece's own pattern.
KNOB1-**KNOB4** (in the sequencer)	Euclid, rotation, probability, lane length.

While SEL is held, keys never play notes or effects. Hold SEL on its own for a moment and a card pops up listing what shift does on the page you're on.

13 SETTINGS, VISUALIZERS AND WHAT IS REMEMBERED



The settings page

To open the **settings**, **hold HOME** for just under a second (0.7 s) without turning anything. The settings are their own walk, apart from the effects' pages: turn **SELECT** to go through **FILTERS**, **SCREAM**, **Settings**, **Auto DJ**, **SET**, **USB & MIDI**, **MIDI IN**, **SCREEN** and **SAMPLE**. FILTERS and SCREAM come first because they belong to the piece: each piece keeps its own, saved with it (**GLO**, then **SAVE**), and a piece without any plays the defaults. It stops at the ends. **FX** leaves.

The Settings page:

KNOB	WHAT IT DOES
Key	A key change for the drop: same, +2, +3, +5 or +7 semitones. When a breakdown or build ends and the groove comes back in, the whole piece moves up by this much for that round. The next breakdown, a stop or another piece moves it back. `KEY` shows in the header while it's on.
Voices	Which set of DX7 voices the pluck uses: **DY**, thirty human-made voices from public-domain banks (the default), or **DX**, the thirty built-in ones.
Form	**Song** (the default): a piece moves through its own drum patterns, a new one every 8 bars (16 in the slower genres), with a fill just before each change, so it plays like a track. **Loop**: it stays on its first pattern, for when you want to steer it yourself. If you set Drum drift (**SEQ** x4), yours plays instead, in either.
Start	**Last** (the default): the FM-1 switches on to the piece you last played, as it is saved (unsaved changes are not kept: save with **GLO**, then **SAVE**). **Random**: a piece of HYPNO at random, the old way.

The SCREEN page

KNOB	WHAT IT DOES
Zoom	Off or on. With Zoom on, turning any knob fills the middle of the screen with its name and value in large type for a second, on any page. It's for playing at a distance, outdoors, or on camera.
Saver	The screensaver: off, 1, 3 or 10 minutes. If you leave the FM-1 alone while it plays, the visualizers (the AUTO one) take over the **whole screen**, with no header and no knobs. Any key, button or knob brings the page back. It doesn't come on in the FX menu or while a visualizer is already up.
Lights	Off or show. With show, the key lights join in with the visualizers. In a groove you get two chasers and flashes on the kick and snare. In a breakdown they slowly pulse. In a build they fill up.
Scanlines	Off or on. Darkens every other row of the screen by a quarter, like an old CRT TV.

The sampling helper (SAMPLE)

The **SAMPLE** page plays PERF-1's sounds one at a time, so a sampler (an MPC sampling its input, say) can record them and your project keeps them without the FM-1. It's the last settings page.

KNOB	WHAT IT DOES
Sounds	**All**, **Drums** or **Synths**: press any key to start a run. **By key**: the white keys play one sound each.
FX	**Off** (dry): no echo, reverb, effects or FX knobs while the page is up. **On**: the piece's own effects.
Gap	The time between sounds in a run: 0.5, 1, 2 or 4 seconds. Use a longer gap for the pad and bass tails.

A run. Start your sampler recording, then press a key. The music stops, there's a count-in of 1.5 seconds, and then each sound plays once, Gap apart: the six drums (kick, snare, clap, hat, open hat, perc), then the pad (a chord), the bass, the acid and the pluck, each on the scale's root. Record it as one sample and chop it into pads. Press a key again to stop early.

By key. White keys 1-6 are the drums, 7-10 the pad, bass, acid and pluck. A synth sound holds as long as the key does. The ten keys are lit while the page is up.

The sounds are those of the piece that was playing: its kit, its sounds, its key. Pick the piece first, then open the page.

Visualizers



DISCO, with the dancer on the drum pattern



KALEIDO

The visualizers are animations that move with the music. Press **HOME twice quickly** from anywhere to open them, and **HOME** again to go back to the Perform screen. Turn the **SELECT** dial to choose one. Your choice is remembered.

While a visualizer is up, the knobs are still the FX knobs, **ALGORITHM** still sets the mood, and the keys still set the track mix, as on Perform. **FX** opens its menu over the picture. Everything is drawn in your theme's colours and follows the kicks and snares, the level of each part, the chord, the pattern and the section.

VISUALIZER	WHAT YOU SEE
PLASMA	A field of colour that swirls faster as the music gets more intense, and flashes on the kick.
KALEIDO	Curves drawn from the sound, mirrored four ways like a kaleidoscope, turning and fading. A kick throws out a ring.
BARS	A real spectrum analyser: 24 bars from 70 Hz (low) to 10 kHz (high).
FLUX	A media-player style light show: the spectrum folded back on itself into a trippy bloom.
DISCO	The mascot dancing in a room with a disco ball, light beams and a floor that lights up along with the drum pattern. He jumps on the kicks and changes moves every couple of bars (sway, twirl, wave, headbang, stomp). He sleeps in a breakdown, shakes in a build, and jumps with confetti on the drop.
LIFE	A Game of Life style pattern of cells that the drums feed: the kick drops a cluster, the snare a spray, a hat a spark.
ORBIT	A looping line drawing (a harmonograph) made from the notes of the chord. It changes shape with every chord.
TRIP	A kaleidoscope you fall through: mirrored slices (six, or eight when the chord has four notes) rushing towards you. The kick throws you forward and the picture breathes in, the snare turns the twist the other way, a build winds it tighter bar by bar, the hats strike sparks, and a breakdown drifts.
THEORY	The harmony as it plays, drawn like the circle of fifths in a theory book. **The circle:** C at the top, then clockwise a fifth further each step. The inner ring is every key's **key signature** (0, 1#, 2# .. 6#, 5b .. 1b): the one for your key is lit, so you can read "E major has 4 sharps" straight off it. The scale lies on the circle as **one arc** (a mode's seven notes are always neighbours on the circle of fifths), with each chord's **Roman numeral** on it (upper case major, lower case minor, ° diminished), coloured by its job as theory books group them: the tonic's family (I, iii, vi) in the pad's colour, the subdominant's (ii, IV) in the bass's, the dominant's (V, vii) in the acid's, and the function's name on the right in the same colour: the chord playing is filled, the next one ringed, a curved arrow swoops from one to the other (your progression's next chord, or the genre's own, which it picks one chord ahead), and the last move stays behind it for half the chord before it fades, so you see the progression jump around the circle. The outer ring names every note **the way the key spells it**: G# in E major (not Ab), Cb in Eb minor, E# in F# major. The chord's notes are marked; a note borrowed from outside the scale, like the G# in A minor's E7, is **red**. **The right side:** the chord's numeral, its name and its notes (spelled the same way), what the chord does (tonic, subdominant, dominant ..; **V OF THE NEXT** in red when the genre makes it the next chord's dominant, **BORROWED** when it comes from the parallel minor), the next chord and how the root gets there (a fifth down, a step up; "home" when it falls a fifth to the tonic), your progression's eight slots as a chord chart, and at the bottom the key and its signature with the major key it's written in ("0: C MAJOR" for A minor). With your progression off, the slots show the genre's walk as it was heard.

VISUALIZER	WHAT YOU SEE
AUTO	Picks one of the light shows (not THEORY), and switches to a new one at each section change and every 32 bars.



The screensaver has the whole screen

What is remembered across power-off

KEPT
The pieces you stored (Global, **SAVE**), in any genre, with their FILTERS and SCREAM settings, their drum drift and their cho
Theme, Tune, MIDI out, the set list, Zoom, the SET page's Mix
Every effect's settings, the gate's pattern and targets, the Auto DJ settings (scenes timing, groove, break, fill), the SET pag
Your DX7 voices
The panel calibration (if you ran it)

"A couple of seconds" is 2 seconds with the music stopped and 4 seconds while it plays. While it plays, the sound dips for a moment during the save, the same as when you store a piece: the music fades out, the FM-1 saves, and the music fades back in.

Not kept: the genre (the FM-1 always starts in HYPNO), anything latched in FX, the FX knobs, the mood, mutes and solos, scenes, whether the auto-DJ is on, and edits to a piece you haven't stored. Also, each genre sets its own tape, vinyl and pump settings when you switch to it. The settings you saved while in HYPNO come back when you return to it.

Backing up and restoring

Installing another firmware, or reinstalling, can wipe what PERF-1 has stored. The **Back up and restore** card on the installer page (below the DX7 voices) protects it:

- **Save a backup** reads everything the FM-1 has stored and saves it as a `.p1bak` file: the pieces you saved in every genre, the settings, the DX7 voices, the theme, Tune and MIDI out. Do this *before* you install anything else. Changes to a piece that you haven't stored aren't included (store them first, section 6). The panel calibration isn't included either, because it belongs to that particular unit.
- **Restore the chosen backup** (choose the file first) writes everything in the file back, one item at a time, then the FM-1 restarts. It replaces what is stored now. The music fades out for each write, and nothing else is saved until the restart. A backup from an older PERF-1 loads into a newer one. Anything in the file the firmware doesn't recognise is refused and never written.
- Only PERF-1 reads these files, and the FM-1 must be running PERF-1 0.14 or later. An older version doesn't answer, and the page tells you so.

Sharing pieces

The **Pieces** page on the PERF-1 website shares one piece at a time: you send a piece you made to someone else, and you add the pieces other people share. Plug the FM-1 in by USB and open the page in Chrome or Edge.

What goes with a piece: all of its settings, its six drum patterns and step tricks, a frozen acid or pluck line, your chord progression, and the DX7 voice its pluck plays if that voice is one you loaded yourself (section 15). Your effects settings, the theme and the set list stay yours.

To share a piece:

1. Store it on the FM-1 (**GLO**, then **SAVE**). Only stored pieces can be shared.
2. On the website's **Library & pieces** page, open **My FM-1**, press **Read my pieces and set list** and tick the piece (or several: **Tick all** ticks every one).
3. Add a title, your name and a note if you like (what to play, what to try). With several ticked, your name goes with each, and each keeps its own genre and number as its name.
4. **Submit to the Library** puts it in the Library for everyone at once. **Download .piece** saves a small file (several download as one `.zip`). **Copy link** copies a link that opens the page with your piece in it, ready to add (several: one link a line). **Copy code** copies the same thing as text, starting `P1.`, for places where links don't work.

To add a shared piece:

1. Open the link, or paste the code into the box, or choose the `.piece` file. The page shows the piece's genre and number, tempo, key and pluck sound, and the title and note if it has them.

2. Choose where it goes. It always goes into its own genre; you pick which of the ten pieces it replaces. It starts on the number it had.
3. Press **Add to my FM-1**. If you already stored a piece there, the page asks before it replaces it.
4. The FM-1 restarts to load it. Then go to the genre (**GLO** + **PRESETS**) and the piece (**PRESETS**). Store what you were playing before you add a piece, because the restart loses changes you haven't stored.

Its DX7 voice. If the piece's pluck plays its own DX7 voice, the voice comes with it:

- If you already have that voice loaded, nothing changes and the piece uses yours.
- If the voice's slot on your FM-1 is empty, the voice goes there.
- If the slot holds a different voice of yours, the page asks: put the new voice in your next empty slot (nothing of yours changes), or replace your voice in that slot. Replacing it changes the sound of any of your pieces that use the old voice.

Hear it in the emulator puts the piece into the browser emulator (section 17) instead, with its voice, so you can listen before you add it to your FM-1.

Sharing a whole set. The first row after **Read my pieces and set list** is **My set list**: your set list (section 10) with every piece in it, their DX7 voices, Play and the SET page's Mix. Pieces you stored go with it; a factory piece is the same on every FM-1, so only its place is sent. It downloads as a `.perfset` file, or copies as a link or code (a long one: for a set with many stored pieces, share the file where links are cut short, as in a Discord message). Adding a set puts each stored piece back at its own number in its genre, its voices in your empty voice slots (a voice you already have is used as it is), and replaces your set list with it. The page lists the stored pieces of yours it would replace and asks first.

The card. Card draws a picture of the piece or set to post with its link: its name, title, maker, tempo and key, and its drum pattern as rings (one ring a drum, the kick inside, sixteen steps round), or a set's places as a ring. **Save the card (PNG)** downloads it.

Based on. When you add a piece from a share, this browser remembers where it came from. If you change it, store it and share it again, it goes out as "based on" the original (its title and maker), and the card says so. If you share it unchanged, the page fills in its original title and maker for you.

The Library. The **Library** tab of the **Library & pieces** page collects pieces and sets people made: each with its card, title, maker and note, to hear in the emulator or add to your FM-1 (**Hear or add**). Filter it by genre, search it, or show only the maker's **picked** ones, the newest, or yours. To put yours in, tick them on **My FM-1** and press **Submit**: they are there at once, for everyone, with no account. A submission is checked first (it has to be a real PERF-1 piece or set; the title, name and note short

and plain). What you submitted from a browser can be taken back from the same browser: its card there has **Remove**.

Versions. Both of you need PERF-1 0.16.3 or later to add a piece. A piece made on an older PERF-1 loads into a newer one: anything it doesn't have yet plays as the piece's genre sets it. A piece made on a newer PERF-1 loads into an older one without the newer settings, and the page tells you so.

14 THEMES AND MIDI



Global

The **Global** page (**GLO**) has four knobs:

- **Root**: the key the music is in.
- **Theme**: the colours. Choose Imp, Synth, Acid, Ice, Ember or Phosphor.
- **Tune**: fine tuning, +-50 cents (a cent is a hundredth of a semitone).
- **Genre**: the bank of pieces, the same as **GLO** + **PRESETS**.

MIDI out and the USB audio level are on the **USB & MIDI** settings page. Hold **HOME** for the settings and turn **SELECT** to it.

Synth is a look of its own, the Synth Imp, shown below. A night sky sits behind the sigil, with a striped sun on the horizon. The sun sinks in a breakdown, rises through a build and flashes on the drop. A floor of lines runs towards the horizon once a beat, and the imp glows like a neon tube.



The Synth look: the home screen

All the other themes are colour versions of the Imp look. The background is a warm black, and each voice keeps one colour everywhere. In Imp, the pad is bone white, the bass crimson, the acid lime, the pluck ice-teal and the drums pink. The ember colour marks whatever is happening right now.

Along the top of the header is a beat bar. The beats are taller marks, and the step playing is lit. Under it is a coil, the slinky's spring, which stretches on each kick. A piece waiting for the next bar shows as `>08` beside the key and mode.

The knob strip at the bottom has **tabs**. Each tab is one group of pages. The tab you're in opens up to show its name, with a dot for each page. The knob values are shown large, with a bar under each. Hold **SEL** and the tabs are replaced by a one-line hint of what shift does on this page.

The theme, Tune and MIDI out apply to all pieces.

MIDI out (over USB): the FM-1 sends what it plays as MIDI notes, so you can record them or drive other synths.

PART	MIDI CHANNEL
Pad	1
Pluck	2
Bass	3
Acid	4
Drums	10 (General MIDI drum notes)

It also sends MIDI clock (the tempo signal other gear follows) with start, continue and stop. A pluck note lasts as long as it sounds (a plain sound's decay, or a DX voice's key time), and its level is sent as the velocity. The DJ snips are not sent. Notes you play by hand go out on their voice's channel. You can switch MIDI out off on the USB & MIDI settings page.

MIDI map: playing a sampler's drums. The third knob on the USB & MIDI page sends the drums where a sampler plays them with little or no setup on the sampler. Load your kick, snare, clap, closed hat, open hat and perc samples as shown below. The samplers' maps send the drums and the clock only: the pad, pluck, bass and acid would land on the sampler's other pads or tracks, so they aren't sent.

MAP	KICK	SNARE	CLAP	CLOSED HAT	OPEN HAT	PERC
GM	ch 10, note 36	38	39	42	46	37
M:Samples	track 1 (ch 1)	track 2 (ch 2)	track 3 (ch 3)	track 4 (ch 4)	track 5 (ch 5)	track 6 (ch 6)
MPC Sample	pad A01 (ch 1, note 36)	A02 (37)	A03 (38)	A04 (39)	A05 (40)	A06 (41)
SP-404	pad 13 of bank A (ch 1, note 36)	pad 14 (37)	pad 15 (38)	pad 16 (39)	pad 9 (40)	pad 10 (41)

The FM-1 sends MIDI over its USB port only (its TRS jack is an input), and the samplers are USB devices too. So the notes need a computer in between (route the FM-1's MIDI to the sampler in your music software), or a USB MIDI host box that joins two USB devices.

On the sampler:

- **Model:Samples:** its tracks listen on channels 1-6 as they come. Each hit is note 36, the sample's own pitch. Set the MIDI input to USB (or MIDI, for a host box with a DIN or TRS out), and turn clock in on to follow PERF-1's tempo.
- **MPC Sample:** set the MIDI port to USB (or External), Pad MIDI In on, the MIDI In channel to All or 1, and MIDI Sync In to MIDI Clock. The notes follow the MPC's default pad map, bank A.
- **SP-404MKII:** set MIDI mode A, where channel 1 plays bank A, and MIDI Sync to Auto. The pads are counted as Roland counts them: 13 to 16 is the bottom row.

These maps follow the samplers' manuals and default settings (for the MPC Sample, the pad map in its default project). They haven't all been tried on the real boxes yet, so if a pad doesn't answer, check the sampler's MIDI settings first, and tell us what you found.

MIDI in: notes on channel 1 add their note to the scale, or remove it if it's already there. MIDI clock and start / stop from other gear set the tempo, and `EXT` shows where the tempo usually is. The FM-1 listens on its USB MIDI port, and on the TRS MIDI input where the build has one.

Playing PERF-1 from a pad controller. An MPC, or any box with pads that sends MIDI notes, can play PERF-1. Connect the pad box's MIDI out to the FM-1's TRS MIDI input with a 3.5 mm TRS MIDI cable (both ends type A for an MPC Sample), or over USB through a computer. Then open the **MIDI IN** settings page (hold **HOME**, then turn **SELECT** past USB & MIDI) and set **Notes** to **Pads**. **Channel** listens to all channels, or only the one you pick.

The pads are read in banks of 16, from note 36, the way an MPC's pads come out of the box (bank A is notes 36-51, bank B 52-67, and so on):

BANK	PADS
A	1-6: the drums (kick, snare, clap, closed hat, open hat, perc), with the pad's velocity. 7: all the drums muted, or back. 9: breakdown. 10: build. 11: drop. 12: the next chord. 13: a fill. 14: freeze. 15: the auto-DJ on or off. 16: the next piece. The sections, chords and pieces wait for the bar, as from the panel.
B	The pluck: each pad is the next note of the scale up from the root, so every pad is in key. The pad's velocity sets the note's level (on the acid, hit hard for an accent), as it does for the drums.
C	The bass, the same way.
D	The acid, the same way.
E	The chords: pads 1-7 jump to the scale's chords I to VII at once.

On an MPC Sample, turn on **Pad MIDI Out** so the pads send notes, and set its MIDI port to External for the TRS cable. With Notes on Pads, channel 1 notes no longer change the scale; set it back to Scale for that.

USB host: plugging a MIDI device straight into the FM-1. Normally the FM-1's USB port is a device: a computer plugs into it. Turn **USB host** on (the MIDI IN page's third knob) and the port becomes the host instead, so a class-compliant USB MIDI device plugs straight in: an MPC Sample, a keyboard, a pad controller, a groovebox. Its notes, clock and transport come in like any MIDI in (so with Notes on Pads its pads play PERF-1), and PERF-1's MIDI out goes to it, following the MIDI map.

- **Power:** the FM-1 doesn't power the port. Plug the device in through a **powered USB hub**, or an adapter that powers the device. One device, directly or behind one hub.

- **While it's on,** the computer side of the port is off: no USB audio, no MIDI to the computer, no editor, no updates. Turn it off to get them back. It's never kept: every power-on starts with USB host off, so the installer always works.
- **What it says:** `ON: PLUG IN A DEVICE`, then `DEVICE CONNECTED` when it finds one. `NO MIDI DEVICE` means it found something without USB MIDI, or nothing answered: the MIDI IN page then shows what it found (`NO ANSWER` with its codes, `HUB INSIDE` for a dock with a hub behind its hub, or the device and the step it stopped at). The page also shows the last MIDI message that came in and whether a clock is coming in, from any input. Low-speed devices (some old keyboards) aren't supported. `DEVICE LOST: LOOKING` means it came unplugged; it reconnects by itself.
- Full-speed USB MIDI 1.0 only, notes and clock: no SysEx goes to or comes from the device.

This is Melodee's USB host (by Kerem Kilic). Receiving from a device has been tried on hardware with Melodee; sending to a device hasn't been yet, so if your device doesn't answer PERF-1's notes, say so.

A Model:Samples (or any Elektron Model) as a controller. The Model:Samples sends each of its six tracks on its own channel (1-6), at whatever note that track is pitched to, so the **Pads** layout doesn't fit it. Set **Notes** to **M:S** instead, and the channel decides what a trig does, whatever its note:

M:S TRACK (CHANNEL)	1	2	3	4	5	6
PERF-1	Next chord	Fill	Breakdown	Build	Drop	Next piece

The sections and pieces wait for the bar, as they do from the pads. Connect its MIDI out to the FM-1's TRS MIDI input. On the Model:Samples, turn on MIDI out for the tracks you want to use as triggers and leave it off for the ones you play yourself. Its trigs still play their own samples, so a trigger track can be a quiet one, or one you like hearing with the change.

An Akai MPK mini as the keyboard. Set **Notes** to **MPK**. Connect its MIDI out to the FM-1's TRS MIDI input (the MPK mini MK4's DIN MIDI out, with a TRS type A to DIN cable or adapter), or over USB through a computer. It expects the MPK's factory program: keys on channel 1, pads on channel 10 from note 36, knobs on CC 24-31 (the MK4's; an older MPK mini's CC 70-77 work too). The MK4's knobs turn endlessly and send steps, so PERF-1 moves each setting from where it is, about fifty clicks from one end to the other; an older MPK's knobs (CC 70-77) set the value straight to where the knob points.

MPK	PERF-1
Keys	Play the Jam page's voice (pluck, pad, acid or bass) with their velocity, snapped to the scale, so there are no wrong notes. With Jam's Keys on Chords, every key plays a triad of the scale.
Pads, bank A (1-8)	The drums (kick, snare, clap, closed hat, open hat, perc), with velocity; pad 7 mutes all the drums or brings them back.
Pads, bank B (9-16)	Breakdown, build, drop, next chord, fill, freeze, auto-DJ on or off, next piece (as the MPC's pads 9-16).
Knobs 1-4 (CC 24-27)	The FX knobs: Filter, Crush, Throw, Wash.
Knobs 5-7 (CC 28-30)	The acid's cutoff and resonance, the bass's cutoff.
Knob 8 (CC 31)	The mood.
Pitch bend	Bends the voice the keys play, two semitones each way.
Mod wheel (CC 1)	Vibrato on the voice the keys play, up to half a semitone each way.

The keys play over the song from any page. On the Jam page the voice is all yours: its own line stops while the page is up. The **Channel** setting doesn't apply in this mode (keys and pads come on their own channels). The bend and vibrato work on the pluck (plain and DX sounds), the bass and the acid, not the pad, and they bend that voice's own line too while you hold them. If your MPK's program sends other numbers, the MIDI IN page's `LAST IN` line shows what each knob and pad sends; tell us and we'll match it.

Knob CCs (the MIDI IN page's fourth knob) turn the four FX knobs over MIDI:

FX KNOB	CC	ON A MODEL:SAMPLES
Filter (open in the middle)	74	Filter cutoff
Crush	71	Resonance
Throw	12	Delay send
Wash	13	Reverb send
Mood (in only)	1	(the mod wheel on a keyboard)

- **In:** these CCs on the listened channel (**Channel**, All by default) move PERF-1's FX knobs. On a Model:Samples, turn on its knobs' MIDI out (ENCS), and its filter, resonance, delay send and reverb send knobs play PERF-1's Filter, Crush, Throw and Wash.
- **Out:** turning PERF-1's FX knobs sends the same CCs on every channel the **MIDI map** uses (GM: 1-4 and 10; M:Samples: 1-6, so the filter sweeps all six tracks at once). It needs MIDI out on, and it goes out over USB, so the same limits apply as for notes (below). A CC that came in isn't sent back out.
- **In+Out:** both.

Freeze from MIDI: CC 64, the sustain pedal's number, works like holding **REC**: the chord freezes while the pedal is down (or the CC is 64 or more) and thaws when it's let up. It works in every Notes mode, on the listened channel, so a pedal on a keyboard or a button in an editor can freeze PERF-1. Start, Continue and Stop always start and stop the music.

Any controller as the panel: a map you make with MIDI learn in the emulator turns any controller's pads, keys, buttons and knobs into the FM-1's own (section 17, "Your MIDI map on the FM-1"). It takes its messages before everything above.

What the FM-1 can't do here: its TRS jack is an input, so nothing goes back to the Model:Samples over TRS. PERF-1's notes and knob CCs reach it only over USB, through a computer, a USB MIDI host box, or the FM-1's own USB host (above; not yet tried with a Model:Samples). Clock works both ways: PERF-1 follows the Model:Samples' clock over TRS, or sends its own over USB.

USB audio: the FM-1 also shows up on a computer as a stereo USB audio input (16-bit, 44.1 kHz). It carries the master output, so you can record the FM-1 over the same cable. On the USB & MIDI settings page, the level can follow the **MASTER** knob (KNOB) or stay at a fixed level (FIXED, about the same as the knob at three quarters). With FIXED you can turn your speakers down without changing the recording.

15 YOUR OWN DX7 VOICES

The DX7 was Yamaha's classic FM synth, and thousands of its sounds (voices) are free online as `.syx` files. PERF-1 can hold **16 of your own DX7 voices** and plays them on the pluck. They stay stored when you switch off. On the Pluck page they come after the 22 built-in DX sounds: use the Sound knob, or **SEL** + **ALGORITHM** on a pluck page. Each shows as `DX` and the voice's own name (ten characters).

Loading them from the installer page

1. Open the installer and find **Load DX7 voices**.
2. Choose one or more `.syx` files. A 32-voice bank, single voices or a bare 4096-byte bank all work. The voices in them are listed.
3. Tick up to 16 and press **Send the chosen voices**. The page clears what is loaded and sends them in order.

Clear the loaded voices empties the slots.

The FM-1 must be running PERF-1 and connected. Use Chrome or Edge, allow MIDI with SysEx (the kind of MIDI message that carries sound data) when the browser asks, and make sure nothing else is using the FM-1's MIDI port. If the FM-1 doesn't answer, the page says `The FM-1 did not answer (an older firmware?)`.

Loading them from a MIDI librarian

You can also send a DX7 SysEx dump from any MIDI librarian app to the FM-1's USB MIDI port.

- A **32-voice bank** replaces the loaded voices with its first 16.
- A **single voice** is added after the last one loaded. If all 16 slots are full, it replaces the last one.

Both are checked against the DX7's checksum, so a damaged file is rejected. The header tells you what happened: `DX7 VOICES 16 LOADED`, `1 ADDED`, `CLEARED`, `BAD CHECKSUM` or `NOT TAKEN`.

(For people writing their own tools: the page uses its own message too, `F0 7D 50 56`, slot, 128 bytes, checksum, `F7`. `7F` alone clears. The FM-1 answers `F0 7D 50 57` so a sender can wait for each voice.)

Good to know

- Voices are saved a couple of seconds after your last change (the music dips, as for any save) and are still there after power-off.
- A voice plays as it was made: the algorithm, the envelopes and their scaling, velocity, LFO, pitch envelope and feedback. Pitch bend, mod wheel, portamento and mono mode aren't supported yet. You can edit the voice itself on the editor page (below).
- Loaded voices are **not level-matched**, to each other or to the other sounds, and play up to four notes at once. If one is too loud or too quiet, turn the pluck's Level.
- A piece remembers the pluck's sound **by slot number**. If it uses your voice in slot 3 and you then load other voices, it plays whatever is in slot 3 now. The factory pieces never use your slots.
- The Sound knob can land on an empty slot, shown as `(empty)`, which makes no sound. **SEL** + **ALGORITHM** skips empty slots.

Editing them: the editor page

The editor lets you change sounds and DX7 voices from a computer. Use Chrome or Edge, with the FM-1 on USB, MIDI with SysEx allowed, and nothing else using the FM-1's MIDI port. It has two tabs.

Sound has every setting from the FM-1's own pages (Tempo, Pad, Pad env, Pad LFO, Chords, Bass, Bass env, Bass LFO, Acid, Acid env, Acid line, Pluck, Pluck 2, Drums, Links, Kit, Drum drift, Space, Reverb, Comp/Limit, Mixer, Global), with the same names, ranges and values. A last page has the rest: each drum lane's level, tune, decay, probability and length, each layer's pan and send, the noise, the octaves and the by-hand switches.

Moving a control changes the piece that's playing, just like turning the knob. **To keep the change, store the piece on the FM-1 itself** (GLO page, **SAVE**). The page reads the FM-1's values when it connects, and again when you press **Read everything from the FM-1**, so what you see is what the FM-1 holds. The ↺ button puts a setting back to its default.

DX7 voices edits the 16 slots. Press **Read the slots from the FM-1**, pick a slot and edit:

- the voice's name
- the **algorithm** (how the six operators are wired together). All 32 are drawn, with the operators you hear (carriers) marked and a curl for feedback. Click an operator in the drawing to edit it.
- feedback, oscillator sync, transpose, the pitch envelope and the LFO
- for each of the six operators: output level, ratio or fixed frequency (coarse, fine, detune), the four-stage envelope (with a graph), level scaling (break point, left and right depth and curve), rate scaling, amplitude-modulation sensitivity and velocity sensitivity.

With **Live** on, every change goes to the slot as you make it, so the pluck plays what you're editing. **Choose it on the pluck** sets the pluck to that slot. Slots fill in order, so send to the next free one to add a voice. **Init voice** starts from a plain sine wave.

Choose files loads `.syx` banks and single voices into a list you can take voices from (click one to edit it). **Save the slots as a bank** and **Save this voice** write `.syx` files for a librarian or for later. The FM-1 saves the slots a couple of seconds after your last change.

16 LOAD, TELEMETRY AND THE LOGGER

Read this if the sound crackles or stutters, or if you want to report a problem. It explains the small numbers on the home screen and how to record a status log to send with a bug report.

The load line on screen

On the home pages, under the drum pattern, there's a line like `CPU 41 XR 0`, with `C2 38` and `S1` below it. Hold **GLO** and the same line is at the top right of the mix map, with the auto-DJ's phase beneath it.

YOU SEE	IT MEANS
CPU nn	How hard the FM-1 is working to make the sound, in percent. Drawing the screen doesn't count.
XR n	How many dropouts there have been. Each one is a click or a stutter, where a tiny bit of sound repeats. If this number goes up, you heard a glitch.
C2 nn	The FM-1's second processor is helping, and is nn % busy.
C1	The second processor stopped after a fault, and everything runs on one until you switch off. Switching off and on again brings it back.
S1	The FM-1 is easing off to keep up. The pad's chorus is off and the DX voices are limited to four notes at once.
S2	Easing off further. The DX voices are limited to two notes.

The FM-1 eases off one step when there's a dropout, or when it nearly runs out of time six times within ten seconds. It goes back one step after twenty seconds without either. With `S1` or `S2` on, the sound is a little thinner, but not broken.

The heaviest combinations are the DX plucks with the shimmer reverb, and the fast genres (dnb, breaks). If you hear crackles there, that's the likely cause.

There's always a delay of a few milliseconds between pressing a key and hearing it. The DX plucks come in very slightly later than the plain sounds.

Recording a status log in the browser

The easiest way to record what's happening:

1. Connect the FM-1 by USB and open the installer page.
2. Find the **Live status** panel and press **Start**. It asks the FM-1 for its numbers four times a second and shows the CPU, the second processor, dropouts, the longest render against its budget, what is shed or moved to the other processor, the genre and piece, the flash writes and the frames drawn.
3. Play the piece that crackles for a minute or so.
4. Press **Save CSV** to save the log as a file.
5. Attach the file to a bug report, with the piece, its sounds and the tempo (section 19 has the link).

Recording with the logger (for people comfortable with Python)

The PERF-1 source has a small Python tool that records the same kind of log from a computer.

1. Install what it needs: `pip install mido python-rtmidi`.
2. With the FM-1 on USB, run `python tools/fm1log.py`. Use `--list` to see the MIDI ports, and `--port` and `--out` to choose a port and a file name.
3. It writes `telemetry/fm1_<time>.csv`. Send that file.

`python tools/fm1sum.py telemetry/<file>.csv` prints a summary of the load, dropouts and stage times for each genre and piece. Don't use `fm1log.py --bench` while making music: it's a development test that causes one glitch.

The FM-1 sends nothing until it's asked, and stops ten seconds after the last ask. If it's busy it skips a reading rather than wait, so logging can't hold up the music.

Details for helpers

ITEM	DETAIL
CPU nn	Share of the render's time budget the first core uses, measured inside the audio interrupt, including waiting for the second core. Screen drawing isn't counted.
XR n (xruns)	Halves of audio that were never rendered; the last 11.6 ms play a second time. A render that only ran past its half isn't counted, since the next starts at once and nothing is lost. The status log counts those as `late`.
C2 nn	Percent of a chunk's time the second core spends on its job: the pad with its chorus, the DX voices, the reverb, and at times the bass and acid. The engine moves some of this work between the cores as the load changes. `C1`: the second core stopped after a fault.
Shedding	S1: pad chorus off, DX voices held to four. S2: DX voices held to two. Steps up on an xrun or on six late renders in ten seconds, one level at a time; steps back one level after twenty seconds of neither.
Audio blocks	512 frames at a time, as two renders of 256 (11.6 ms for the pair), so a slow render borrows time from a quick one beside it. The DX plucks are rendered a chunk ahead on the second core and sound 5.8 ms later than the plain ones.
Logger columns	CPU and CPU1 %, xruns, the longest render since the last frame against its budget, the longest gap between main-loop turns, the longest screen frame (a flash write or a long frame shows there), the shed level, flash writes (and how long the last one stopped the chip), crashes, the genre and piece, and the first core's time by stage.
Logger events	XRUN, LATE, FLASH, OVER, GAP, SHED.
`fm1log.py --bench`	Times loops on the chip once. Interrupts are off for a few milliseconds, so the music glitches once. For development.

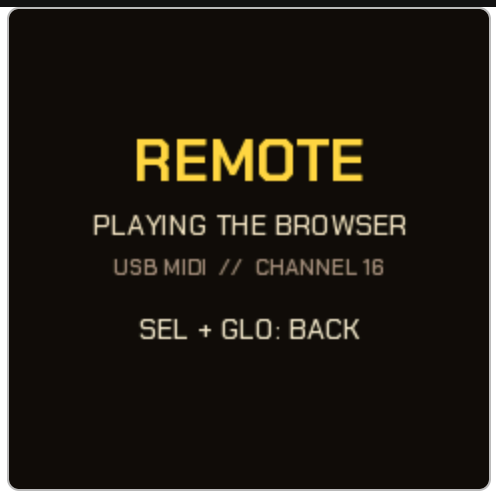
17 THE EMULATOR

The emulator runs the real PERF-1 firmware in your web browser, so you can try it without the FM-1 or follow along with this manual.

- Drag a knob up or down, or scroll over it.
- Click buttons and keys.
- To hold a button down, Shift-click (or right-click) it, and click again to let go. That's how you hold **SEQ**, **SAVE**, **SEL** or **HOME**.
- **New start** switches it off and on. Stored pieces stay, in that browser. **Forget stored** clears them.

COMPUTER KEY	FM-1 CONTROL
Space	**PLAY**
Enter	**REC**
Esc	**HOME**
V / L / P	**ENV** / **LFO** / **ARP**
M	**SEQ** (hold for the sequencer)
O / C / N	**GLO** / **EDIT** / **SEL**
`	**FX**
B	**SAVE**
Z / X	**OCT-** / **OCT+**
Up / Down	**SELECT**
Q-I, A-K	White keys 1-8, 9-16
1-0, -	Black keys 1-11

Playing it from the FM-1 (remote)



The remote screen

You can use the real FM-1's panel to play the emulator, which is handy for streaming or for seeing the screen large.

1. Plug the FM-1 in by USB.
2. Open the emulator in Chrome, Edge or Firefox, switch it on and press **Connect MIDI**. Allow MIDI when the browser asks.
3. On the FM-1, hold **SEL** and press **GLO**. The screen says REMOTE, the FM-1 stops and goes quiet, and its whole panel now plays the emulator: every button, key and knob, **MASTER** too.

The emulator's lights are sent back to the FM-1's buttons and keys, so the panel lights up as usual, but watch the emulator's screen. The FM-1 shows `PLAYING THE BROWSER` while the emulator is answering and `WAITING FOR THE BROWSER` when it isn't. Press **SEL** + **GLO** again to get the FM-1 back. It comes back stopped (**PLAY** starts it).

For livestreams: the emulator's **Stream view** button (or adding `?stream` to the address) puts the FM-1 and its screen, large, on a clean 16:9 stage for OBS or any capture software. Whatever is pressed glows, whether on the real FM-1 through the remote or clicked in the browser. A turning knob gets a ring, and a strip under the screen names the last moves. FM-1 LINKED shows while the remote is on. The small bar (Connect MIDI, Exit) and the mouse pointer hide when the mouse is still.

How it talks, for the curious: USB MIDI channel 16. Keys are notes 48-74, buttons are CC 102-115 (127 down, 0 up), the knobs are CC 85-91 (64 plus or minus the number of clicks), **MASTER** is CC 7, and CC 116 is a hello sent each second. The emulator sends its lights back the same way, with CC 117 each second.

Any other controller (MIDI learn)

You can play the emulator from an FM-1 running M-VAVE's own firmware, or from any MIDI keyboard or controller. As soon as it's connected, its keys play the emulator's keys by pitch, from F3 to G5. Notes outside that range are folded into it.

To use the controller's other buttons and knobs:

1. Press **MIDI learn**.
2. Click a control on the emulator. It gets an outline.
3. Press or move the control you want on your controller.
4. Repeat for as many as you like, then press **Done learning**.

Buttons and keys can take a note or a CC. Knobs take a CC, either absolute (a normal knob or fader) or relative (an endless encoder that turns forever; pick which in the list). The list is kept in that browser. **Forget learned** clears it.

Your MIDI map on the FM-1 (experimental)

Experimental: it works in the tests, and is still being tried on more controllers. Tell us what yours does.

What you learn in the emulator can play the real PERF-1 too, with no computer in between: your controller's pads, keys, buttons and knobs become the FM-1's own buttons, keys and knobs.

1. Learn the controls in the emulator, as above.
2. Press **Send it to your FM-1**. It opens the Install page's **Your MIDI map** section, which lists what you learned.
3. Plug the FM-1 in and press **Send to my FM-1**. The FM-1 keeps the map and restarts.
4. Plug your controller into the FM-1 (USB host, or the TRS MIDI jack), or play it through the computer.

A learned control works in every mode, before anything else PERF-1 does with MIDI: a pad you learned as **PLAY** starts and stops, a fader you learned on **SELECT** walks the pages, an encoder on a page knob turns it. A button or key is held while its note (or its CC at 64 and over) is down, so holds work too (**SEQ** held opens the sequencer, **SEL** held is a shift). Anything you did not learn does what it did before. **MASTER** stays the FM-1's own knob: a learned MASTER works in the emulator only. Up to 48 controls.

Nothing learns? Some controllers keep their pads off MIDI until you turn it on. On an **MPC Sample**: SHIFT + pad 8 (MIDI Config), **MIDI Port** USB (the TRS jacks are External), **Pad MIDI Out** Always. While learning, the emulator shows anything it hears, so you can tell whether the controller is sending at all.

Download .perfmap saves the map as a file to keep or share, and **load one** reads it back (into the emulator too). **Read it from my FM-1** brings the FM-1's map back into

the list to change it. **Clear the FM-1's map** removes it. The map is also in your backups.

A knob on each setting (MIDI CC to settings)

New in 0.16.18, experimental. Tell us how it goes with your controller.

A learned panel knob turns whatever the page on screen shows. A learned **setting** is different: a knob or fader on your controller is tied to one setting (the acid's Cutoff, the reverb, the swing) and sets it on any page, even while the screen shows something else. A controller with 32 knobs and faders can hold 32 settings at once, with no computer in between.

1. Open the **Editor** page in Chrome or Edge and plug your controller into the computer. Connecting the FM-1 too lets you hear each setting while you learn, but it isn't needed.
2. Under **Your controller**, press **Connect a controller**, then **Learn**.
3. Click a setting in the list (for example Acid, Cutoff). It gets an outline.
4. Move the knob or fader you want for it. The setting now shows its CC, for example `CC 21`.
5. Repeat for as many as you like, then press **Done**.
6. Press **Send to my FM-1**. That opens the Install page's **Your MIDI map** section, where the settings are listed with your panel controls. Plug the FM-1 in and press **Send to my FM-1** there. The FM-1 keeps the map and restarts.
7. Plug the controller into the FM-1 (USB host, or the TRS MIDI jack).

How it behaves:

- A fader or knob sets the value straight: the bottom of its travel is the setting's lowest value, the top its highest. It jumps to where the knob is. The FM-1 has no pick-up mode.
- An endless encoder (pick **64 ± n** or **1 up, 127 down** in the list) steps the setting from where it is, one step a click.
- If the page on screen shows that setting, its knob lights up (and zooms, with ZOOM on). On any other page the screen shows the setting's name and value for a moment.
- The change is the same as turning the FM-1's own knob: it belongs to the piece that is playing until you store it (the player's own settings, such as Tune, are kept at once, as always).
- Only CCs, on the channel they were learned on. A setting has one control; learning a new one replaces the old.
- Panel controls (learned in the emulator) and settings share the map: 48 in all.
- An FM-1 with an older PERF-1 refuses a map that has settings. Install 0.16.18 or later first.

Novation Launch Control XL 3: a ready map

Press **Use the Launch Control XL 3 map** on the Editor page (or load launch-control-xl-3.perfmap on the Install page) and send it. It uses the controller's factory custom mode, channel 1: faders CC 5-12, the knobs CC 13-20 (top row), 21-28 (middle) and 29-36 (bottom). If you changed the custom mode in Novation Components, learn your own instead. The buttons are free: learn them as panel buttons in the emulator if you want (PLAY, SEQ and so on).

CONTROL	CC	SETTING	CONTROL	CC	SETTING
Fader 1	5	Pad level	Middle knob 1	21	Acid Cutoff
Fader 2	6	Bass level	Middle knob 2	22	Acid Reso
Fader 3	7	Acid level	Middle knob 3	23	Acid Env mod
Fader 4	8	Pluck level	Middle knob 4	24	Acid Decay
Fader 5	9	Drums level	Middle knob 5	25	Acid Accent
Fader 6	10	Vinyl level	Middle knob 6	26	Acid Slide
Fader 7	11	Echo	Middle knob 7	27	Acid Density
Fader 8	12	Reverb	Middle knob 8	28	Acid Mutate
Top knob 1	13	Pad Bright	Bottom knob 1	29	Drums Drive
Top knob 2	14	Pad Detune	Bottom knob 2	30	Drums Swing
Top knob 3	15	Pad Attack	Bottom knob 3	31	Humanize
Top knob 4	16	Pad Release	Bottom knob 4	32	Ghost notes
Top knob 5	17	Pad Chorus	Bottom knob 5	33	Pluck Density
Top knob 6	18	Bass Cutoff	Bottom knob 6	34	Pluck Decay
Top knob 7	19	Bass Reso	Bottom knob 7	35	Echo time
Top knob 8	20	Bass line Move	Bottom knob 8	36	Reverb Size

Every setting can be learned: the Editor page lists all 176, grouped by voice.

18 TROUBLESHOOTING

No sound. Check the **MASTER** knob, and that **PLAY** is lit. Then check:

- A layer's level may be at 0. Each voice's page has its level on **KNOB1**, and the Mixer shows them all.
- A voice marked `BY HAND` is silent until you play it. **SEL** + **ENV** on its page gives it back to the automatic part.
- A track may be muted on the mix map (hold **GLO** to see it).
- An effect latched in FX can silence things. The header shows `FX` when one is latched.
- On the Jam page, the voice you play stops its own line while that page is up.
- REMOTE silences the FM-1 on purpose (section 17).

A short dip or tick when you change a setting or store a piece. That's normal. While the FM-1 saves, the music fades out and back in. Settings are saved a couple of seconds after your last change, so lots of quick edits make just one dip.

A stored piece came back the way it was before. It was stored while playing and the power went off before the save finished. Stores happen straight away, with a short dip in the sound. Don't switch off during the dip.

Everything I saved is gone after switching off, or an install stops at once. Newer FM-1s (sold since autumn 2026) have a different memory chip. PERF-1 before 0.16.23, and many other firmwares, don't recognise it: they keep your saves only until power-off and can't take an update (the installer says "nothing was written"). Nothing is broken. Install 0.16.23 or newer. If the installer can't reach the FM-1, use a recovery tool such as FM-SWITCH, or the Firmware Hub's rescue page, to put the stock firmware back first. The Install page's Live status shows which chip yours has (P25Q80 or UC25HQ80).

PERF-1 got heavier after I tried M-VAVE's V16 (CPU higher, easing off sooner). V16 also changes the FM-1's startup code, and with it the whole FM-1 runs about 12% slower. Installing PERF-1 again doesn't change that. On the Install page, **Full speed** checks your FM-1 and can put V15's startup code back (it installs M-VAVE's V15, then PERF-1). FM-1s with the newer memory chip stay on V16 for now.

My changes vanished. Only a piece you stored (Global, **SAVE**) is kept. Changes you didn't store are lost when you change genre or switch off. See "What is remembered" in section 13.

The installer doesn't find the FM-1. Use Chrome or Edge and a USB data cable (some cables only charge). Close any music software (DAW) that might be using the FM-1's MIDI port. Allow MIDI with SysEx for the page when asked.

The installer offers an old version. Hard-refresh the page: Ctrl+F5, or Cmd+Shift+R on a Mac.

An install was cut off. Run it again. The FM-1 stays in update mode until an install finishes. If it doesn't come back at all, see "Recovering an FM-1 that won't start" in section 1.

The screen says `PERF-1 SAFE MODE`**.** The FM-1 crashed twice while starting up. Reinstall from the installer, or press **PLAY** to try again.

`UPDATE MODE IN 3..` **appeared.** You were holding **OCT-** and **OCT+** together. Let go before the countdown ends and it cancels.

The buttons or knobs don't match their labels. Run the **hardware calibration** (a Felucca feature). Hold **OCT-** and **OCT+** while you switch the FM-1 on. It asks you to press each button and turn each knob in turn, and saves the result. If you don't touch anything for 30 seconds it gives up and changes nothing.

The DX7 voices I loaded don't show up. Use the pluck's Sound knob, or **SEL** + **ALGORITHM** on a Pluck page. Your voices come after the 30 built-in DX7 voices. Check that the page said they were sent and the header showed `DX7 VOICES n LOADED`, that the pluck's Level isn't 0, and that the FM-1 runs PERF-1 0.11 or later. A bank must pass the DX7 checksum.

Crackles or dropouts. Look at the load line (section 16). `XR` goes up by one with each click. `S1` or `S2` mean the FM-1 is already easing off to keep up. Heavy DX plucks, a shimmer reverb and the fast genres push it hardest. Record a status log for a minute (Live status on the installer page, or `fm1log.py`) and send the CSV to deamonSLINKY, with the piece, its sounds and the tempo.

The emulator doesn't see the FM-1. Close any DAW using the FM-1's MIDI port, and use Chrome, Edge or Firefox (Safari doesn't support Web MIDI). For the FM-1's panel to play the emulator, the FM-1 must be in remote (**SEL** + **GLO**).

MIDI notes change my scale. MIDI notes coming in on channel 1 add and remove notes from the scale. Send on another channel, or unplug the MIDI input.

19 CREDITS

Feedback and contributing. Comments, ideas and bug reports are welcome, and anyone is invited to help: open an issue on GitHub. The source is at <https://github.com/deamonSLINKY/PERF-1>. A bug report helps most when it includes the version (shown on the boot card), the genre and piece, and, for anything about load or crackles, a status log (section 16).

PERF-1 is by **deamonSLINKY**: the firmware, the slinky mascot and the pages around them. It is a fork of **HYP-1**, a RedtailWorks project, which is itself a fork of AMB-1 by Charles Vestal.

The platform (USB, update loader, storage, installer) is Felucca by Leo Kuroshita (@kurogedelic), Hügelton Instruments. It reaches PERF-1 by way of XOX and FoMni. The panel calibration is Felucca's. The boot guard, knob acceleration, help cards and anti-aliased drawing came from XOX.

The six-operator FM that plays the DX7 voices, the factory voices, the second-core work (the reverb, the pad and the DX voices on the FM-1's other processor core) and the safe core hold are from **Melodee** by Kerem Kilic (Ellic Studio, GPL-3.0). The FM itself is after **Dexed** by Pascal Gauthier, on MSFA by Raph Levien (Google; Apache 2.0 / GPL-3.0).

The idea of running FM-1 firmware in the browser comes from Groove OS's emulator. What is known about the FM-1's hardware comes largely from the FM-1-RE reverse-engineering work. The rescue route uses FM-1-transporter's protocol and JieLi's flash loader from kagaimiq's jl-uboot-tool.

The bass modes, the pad's comping rhythms, the ghost notes and accents of the genres, and the deja vu loop in the pluck follow ideas in **Tuna** by delirioux (github.com/delirioux/tuna, GPL-3.0), a generative firmware for the FM-1 on Felucca. Tuna's random section is a port of **Marbles** by Emilie Gillet (Mutable Instruments, MIT). PERF-1's versions are written for its own engine.

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Runners: hold shift and edit the beat.